ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR EVIDENCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Legal Operations and Compliance English

Clarify the request. Preserve the evidence.



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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 Contract Intake and Workflow, page 4

Clarify the agreement, owner, decision need, and document status before routing a contract request.

02 Policy Implementation and Controls, page 17

Translate a policy requirement into an assigned, evidenced process without confusing publication with operation.

03 Compliance Audits and Evidence, page 31

Respond to an evidence request with the correct period, source, completeness, and limitations.

04 Internal Investigations, page 42

Attribute reported events, separate inference from observation, and route sensitive concerns for impartial review.

05 Privacy Operations and Data Requests, page 56

Clarify identity and requested actions, preserve receipt details, and route timing and disclosure decisions correctly.

06 Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence, page 68

Compare vendor data flows and dependencies, identify missing evidence, and communicate unresolved risk accurately.

07 Training, Attestations, and Culture, page 84

Report completion separately from understanding and explain a policy through precise, role-relevant examples.

08 Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees, page 96

Report action status, remaining exposure, and requested decisions against explicit closure criteria.

Professional communication notes, page 3

Three additional workplace cases, page 112

Answers and explanations, page 126

Phrase finder, page 184

Vocabulary index, page 186

References and publication notes, page 191

Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Precise records. Responsible decisions.

Legal operations and compliance teams connect business requests, evidence, specialists, and authorized decisions. These conversations practice clear handoffs and careful distinctions without turning an incomplete record into a legal conclusion or a completed control.

Name the status

Received, assigned, reviewed, approved, signed, implemented, and verified describe different events. Use the status supported by the record and identify what must happen next.
"The plan is approved; implementation evidence is still outstanding."

Keep the source attached to the claim

Separate a reported observation, an interpretation, a document, and an established finding. Attribution makes a record fairer and more useful for qualified review.
"The reporter says the invoice was approved early; the motive has not been established."

Match evidence to the question

A current screenshot cannot automatically prove how a control operated in an earlier period. State the source, period, version, completeness, and any known gap.
"This image shows the current setting, not the requested January-to-March operation."

Coordinate without inventing authority

Make the route and next contact clear. Operational urgency does not confer legal, privacy, investigation, or risk-acceptance authority on the person receiving the request.
"I can coordinate the review; the designated reviewer must decide the exception."

Professional boundaries

All organizations, people, policies, thresholds, cases, and timelines are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not legal advice or a complete compliance program. Follow current applicable law, actual policies, retention and preservation duties, and qualified legal or privacy guidance. Source jurisdictions differ; no example creates a universal rule, deadline, privilege, or legal conclusion.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / CONTRACT INTAKE AND WORKFLOW

Clarify the agreement, owner, decision need, and document status before routing a contract request.

> **Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction**
>
> Ben submits request L17 with the subject Urgent contract. It lacks an agreement type, business owner, and required decision date. Attached is an unsigned vendor service proposal for a two-month, $40,000 software pilot; an earlier nondisclosure agreement is also attached. Intake coordinator Mina must establish the transaction purpose, correct parties, required documents, personal-data involvement, and actual timing. Receipt is not legal approval. The business has not confirmed who can authorize spending or sign. Mina can coordinate triage but cannot decide contract terms or promise immediate signature.

People: Ben, Business requester; Mina, Legal intake coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which information is missing from intake?

A. Every attached document
B. The fact that a pilot is proposed
C. The quoted pilot amount
D. Agreement type, business owner, and required decision date

2. What does the service proposal describe?

A. A two-month software pilot for $40,000
B. An already signed annual license
C. A completed legal approval
D. A nondisclosure agreement with no services

3. What can Mina do?

A. Coordinate triage and route the request
B. Approve legal terms without review
C. Sign for the business automatically
D. Convert urgency into spending authority

Answers and explanations, page 126

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

intake
Receiving and organizing information needed to handle a request.

complete contract intake

triage
Assessing a request to determine its route, priority, and next action.

triage the request

requester
The person submitting a request, not necessarily its decision-maker.

contact the requester

legal entity
An organization or person recognized as capable of relevant legal rights and duties.

confirm the legal entity

NDA
Nondisclosure agreement; terms governing specified confidential information.

locate the NDA

SOW
Statement of work; a document specifying particular work and related terms.

reconcile the SOW

matter
A legal or operational issue tracked as a defined item of work.

open a matter

business owner
The person accountable for the underlying business need.

identify the business owner

counterparty
The other party to the relevant agreement or transaction.

verify the counterparty

agreement type
The category of contract or document being requested.

identify the agreement type

MSA
Master services agreement; overarching terms for specified service arrangements.

review the MSA

order form
A document setting out a particular purchase and its relevant terms.

verify the order form

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

intake INTAKE

complete contract intake

Keep the meaning precise: Receiving and organizing information needed to handle a request.

counterparty COUNTERPARTY

verify the counterparty

Keep the meaning precise: The other party to the relevant agreement or transaction.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

contract package

The related documents that together describe the proposed arrangement.

assemble the contract package

signature authority

Permission to execute the relevant agreement on behalf of a party.

verify signature authority

decision deadline

The time by which a specified decision is needed.

clarify the decision deadline

review scope

The issues and documents included in an assessment.

define the review scope

CLM

Contract lifecycle management; processes and systems for managing contract stages.

maintain the CLM record

turnaround estimate

An estimate of how long a defined response or task will take.

qualify the turnaround estimate

unsigned proposal

Proposed terms that have not been signed in the supplied record.

identify an unsigned proposal

spend approval

Authorization to commit the relevant funds.

obtain spend approval

target signature date

A desired signing date whose commitment status must be clear.

qualify the target signature date

routing rule

A criterion determining where a request is sent.

apply routing rules

version control

Management of document revisions and their status.

maintain version control

legal approval

Approval within the defined legal review process, distinct from other authorizations.

record legal approval

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

order form ORDER FORM

verify the order form

Keep the meaning precise: A document setting out a particular purchase and its relevant terms.

decision deadline DECISION DEADLINE

clarify the decision deadline

Keep the meaning precise: The time by which a specified decision is needed.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the request

I have received L17 and the attached proposal.

Clarify the transaction

What services will the two-month pilot actually include?

Separate the documents

The earlier NDA does not replace the service documents.

Check authority

Who approves the spend, and who is authorized to sign?

Separate two dates

Is that the review deadline or the desired signature date?

Keep status accurate

The proposal is unsigned and has not completed review.

Avoid a turnaround promise

We need the scope and reviewer availability before confirming timing.

Maintain one record

Keep the current version and status in the intake record.

Explain the missing facts

To route it correctly, I need the agreement type, business owner, and decision date.

Verify the parties

Which legal entities would enter the agreement?

Identify the owner

Who is accountable for the business need?

Clarify urgency

What decision is needed by what date, and what happens if it is delayed?

Check data involvement

Will the pilot involve personal data or access to customer systems?

Request the package

Please include the current proposal and all referenced terms.

Route specialist questions

I will flag the data-processing details for the appropriate reviewer.

Close the handoff

I will confirm the route, missing items, and next contact once triage is complete.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Verify the parties
Useful wording: Which legal entities would enter the agreement?

Purpose: Separate the documents
Useful wording: The earlier NDA does not replace the service documents.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which acknowledgment is accurate?

A. L17 is legally approved because the file uploaded successfully.
B. The old NDA authorizes the pilot spend.
C. The requester may sign because the request is urgent.
D. L17 is received; routing information and required approvals remain outstanding.

2. Which question clarifies timing best?

A. Shall we estimate turnaround from the amount before confirming scope?
B. What decision is needed by which date, and how does that differ from desired signature?
C. Shall I use the desired signing date as the only review deadline?
D. Can I use the supplier's reminder date without checking the business decision?

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The person accountable for the underlying business need. Which term fits?

A. signature authority
B. business owner
C. CLM
D. NDA

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction". Ben: "I submitted it for Nell in operations. She owns the pilot objective, although I do not know who approves the final spend." Mina: [missing response] Ben: "The slides say Orbit; the proposal has a longer company name. I nearly shortened it to match. Should I leave it as written?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Thank you. The NDA and the pilot services arrangement have different purposes. We need the current proposal and any referenced service terms, rather than treat the earlier confidentiality document as approval of the whole purchase.

B. Include that uncertainty in the review scope. The data flow and access details may affect which specialists need to review. Please do not answer stored or not stored merely to make the form look complete.

C. I will record Nell as the business owner and leave the spend approver unconfirmed. The person who requests work, the person who owns the need, and the person who can authorize it are not necessarily the same.

D. We need the actual legal entity for each side. Please preserve the name in the document and have the business confirm the intended parties, rather than replace a formal name with the brand from the slides.

Answers and explanations, page 126

One useful distinction

The earlier NDA and the proposed services arrangement serve different purposes. Do not assume the NDA approves the pilot, spending, data processing, or signature. Reviewers need the relevant document package and actual parties, not an intake label alone.

E Conversation

Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction

Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

intake / decision deadline / triage / review scope / turnaround estimate / NDA / version control / legal entity / business owner / signature authority

01 **Ben:** I marked L17 urgent. The supplier is waiting, and the business wants the software pilot moving this week.

02 **Mina:** To complete [1] _____, I need the agreement type, business owner, and required decision date. Those details help us assign the right reviewer without unnecessary transfers.

03 **Ben:** The proposal is for a two-month pilot costing forty thousand dollars. I attached the confidentiality agreement we signed earlier as well.

04 **Mina:** Thank you. The [2] _____ and the pilot services arrangement have different purposes. We need the current proposal and any referenced service terms, rather than treat the earlier confidentiality document as approval of the whole purchase.

05 **Ben:** I submitted it for Nell in operations. She owns the pilot objective, although I do not know who approves the final spend.

06 **Mina:** I will record Nell as the [3] _____ and leave the spend approver unconfirmed. The person who requests work, the person who owns the need, and the person who can authorize it are not necessarily the same.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Ben:** The slides say Orbit; the proposal has a longer company name. I nearly shortened it to match. Should I leave it as written?

08 **Mina:** We need the actual [4] _____ for each side. Please preserve the name in the document and have the business confirm the intended parties, rather than replace a formal name with the brand from the slides.

09 **Ben:** Nell needs a decision about whether to proceed by the sixth of October at noon UTC. She hopes to sign by the ninth.

10 **Mina:** That gives us a specific [5] _____ and a separate target signature date. I will record both and the business consequence of delay, but those dates do not establish reviewer availability or approval.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ben:** The pilot will use customer contact details. I am not sure whether the supplier only views them or also stores a copy.

12 **Mina:** Include that uncertainty in the [6] _____. The data flow and access details may affect which specialists need to review. Please do not answer stored or not stored merely to make the form look complete.

13 **Ben:** There are two versions of the proposal in the email chain. The latest changes the support arrangement, but neither is signed.

14 **Mina:** Keep clear [7] _____. Identify the current revision and preserve the relevant history so the reviewer sees the changed support terms rather than an outdated attachment.

15 **Ben:** Once the legal team reviews it, can I send it for signature, or should I wait for another approval?

16 **Mina:** We must verify [8] _____ and the other required approvals. Legal review does not automatically approve the budget or make you the signer. The actual workflow will identify the necessary sequence.

17 **Ben:** The supplier keeps chasing. Could we say today, even though the reviewer is not confirmed?

18 **Mina:** I cannot give that [9] _____ yet. I can acknowledge receipt and confirm that we are clarifying the route. Once the scope and reviewer availability are known, we can communicate a supported timing expectation.

Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction / continued

19 **Ben:** I will get Nell's confirmation, the party details, the latest proposal, and the data-handling information into the same record.

20 **Mina:** Good. I will complete [10] _____, identify the missing approvals, and confirm the next contact. We can respond to the urgency while keeping receipt, review, approval, and signature as separate statuses.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. intake / **2.** NDA / **3.** business owner / **4.** legal entity / **5.** decision deadline / **6.** review scope / **7.** version control / **8.** signature authority / **9.** turnaround estimate / **10.** triage

Why these answers fit, page 127

F Check accuracy and scope

Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction

Return to the case

Ben submits request L17 with the subject Urgent contract. It lacks an agreement type, business owner, and required decision date. Attached is an unsigned vendor service proposal for a two-month, $40,000 software pilot; an earlier nondisclosure agreement is also attached. Intake coordinator Mina must establish the transaction purpose, correct parties, required documents, personal-data involvement, and actual timing. Receipt is not legal approval. The business has not confirmed who can authorize spending or sign. Mina can coordinate triage but cannot decide contract terms or promise immediate signature.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What should the reviewer receive?

A. The current proposal, referenced terms, party details, business purpose, and relevant data information

B. Only the subject line

C. An older NDA instead of the current services documents

D. A rewritten summary concealing unresolved terms

2. Which distinction is necessary?

A. Requester, business owner, spend approver, and signer may be different roles.

B. Every requester is automatically the authorized signer.

C. Legal approval always approves the budget.

D. A CLM record is equivalent to an executed contract.

Answers and explanations, page 129

Listen for the distinction

Correct the ten gaps. Reread the party-name check and the unresolved customer-data flow without inventing either answer.

Clarification can be helpful under time pressure

A requester may hear questions as delay. Explain which missing facts let the team assign the right reviewer and distinguish a business decision deadline from a hoped-for signature. Acknowledge urgency without promising that required review can be skipped.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Clarify another urgent intake request

Request M22 attaches an unsigned services proposal. Dana owns the business need. A review decision is needed on 5 May; signature is desired on 9 May. The spend approver and authorized signer are not yet confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

5 May / unsigned / Dana / unconfirmed

01 **Coordinator:** The document status is [1] _____.

02 **Requester:** The business owner is [2] _____.

03 **Coordinator:** The decision is needed on [3] _____.

04 **Requester:** The signer remains [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. unsigned / **2.** Dana / **3.** 5 May / **4.** unconfirmed

Why these answers fit, page 129

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction". Ben: "There are two versions of the proposal in the email chain. The latest changes the support arrangement, but neither is signed." Mina: [missing response] Ben: "Once the legal team reviews it, can I send it for signature, or should I wait for another approval?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep clear version control. Identify the current revision and preserve the relevant history so the reviewer sees the changed support terms rather than an outdated attachment.

B. To complete intake, I need the agreement type, business owner, and required decision date. Those details help us assign the right reviewer without unnecessary transfers.

C. We must verify signature authority and the other required approvals. Legal review does not automatically approve the budget or make you the signer. The actual workflow will identify the necessary sequence.

D. Good. I will complete triage, identify the missing approvals, and confirm the next contact. We can respond to the urgency while keeping receipt, review, approval, and signature as separate statuses.

Answers and explanations, page 130

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / POLICY IMPLEMENTATION AND CONTROLS

Translate a policy requirement into an assigned, evidenced process without confusing publication with operation.

> **The policy is published, but the check has no owner**
>
> Fictional company policy H3 requires compliance preapproval before committing to client hospitality costing more than $100 per guest, including all charges. Other restrictions still apply at any amount. H3 was published on 1 September, but the intake check and evidence retention have no assigned operator. A proposed meal costs $960 for eight guests, with no commitment yet made. Policy owner Mara and expense operations lead Dinesh must define who checks the request, who decides, where evidence is kept, and how exceptions are escalated. The event has not been approved.

People: Mara, Compliance policy owner; Dinesh, Expense operations lead.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What triggers the stated H3 preapproval requirement?

A. More than $100 per guest before commitment
B. Exactly $100 or less in every case
C. Only events costing more than $1,000 in total
D. Publication of a new policy regardless of any event

2. What is the proposed cost per guest?

A. $80
B. $120
C. $100
D. $960

3. What is missing from implementation?

A. Confirmation that the event is already approved
B. An assigned check operator and evidence-retention arrangements
C. The existence of any policy
D. The proposed guest count

Answers and explanations, page 131

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

policy
An organization's stated rule or principle for decisions and behavior.

publish a policy

procedure
The defined steps for carrying out a task or requirement.

implement a procedure

control
An action or arrangement designed to address a specified risk or objective.

operate a control

control objective
The intended result of a control.

define the control objective

policy owner
The role responsible for maintaining and interpreting a policy through the authorized process.

identify the policy owner

control operator
The person performing the defined control activity.

assign the control operator

approver
A person authorized to make the relevant approval decision.

verify the approver

preventive control
A control intended to stop an unwanted event before it occurs.

design a preventive control

detective control
A control intended to identify an event or condition after or as it occurs.

operate a detective control

trigger
The condition that requires a defined action.

specify the control trigger

threshold
A boundary used by a rule or decision criterion.

apply the threshold

preapproval
Required approval before the specified action or commitment.

obtain preapproval

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

policy POLICY

publish a policy

Keep the meaning precise: An organization's stated rule or principle for decisions and behavior.

control operator CONTROL OPERATOR

assign the control operator

Keep the meaning precise: The person performing the defined control activity.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

commitment

An undertaking or obligation whose relevant meaning depends on the context.

verify commitment status

evidence repository

The approved location for maintaining supporting records.

use the evidence repository

exception

A departure from a defined requirement, subject to the relevant process.

escalate an exception

segregation of duties

Allocation of incompatible responsibilities to different roles where required.

assess segregation of duties

operating effectiveness

Whether a control works as intended in practice over the relevant scope.

test operating effectiveness

implementation gap

A difference between a requirement and its practical deployment.

close the implementation gap

control evidence

Records supporting whether and how a control was performed.

retain control evidence

retention rule

A requirement governing how long and under what conditions records are kept.

follow retention rules

override

An authorized or unauthorized bypass of a normal control, with status specified.

review control overrides

design effectiveness

Whether a control is suitably designed to address its objective.

assess design effectiveness

control frequency

How often or upon what events a control is performed.

define control frequency

issue escalation

Raising an unresolved problem to the appropriate authority.

document issue escalation

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

preapproval PREAPPROVAL

obtain preapproval

Keep the meaning precise: Required approval before the specified action or commitment.

exception EXCEPTION

escalate an exception

Keep the meaning precise: A departure from a defined requirement, subject to the relevant process.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the gap

The policy is published, but the check has no assigned operator.

Apply the correct basis

The threshold is per guest, including all charges.

Separate trigger and decision

That amount requires review; it does not mean the event is approved.

Assign the activity

Who checks the request before a commitment is made?

Specify the evidence

Retain the request, calculation, decision, reviewer, and timing.

Choose the repository

Store the records in the approved location under the applicable retention rules.

Avoid bypassing the rule

Do not split one event to disguise the amount.

Test the process

Walk a real request through the steps and verify the retained evidence.

Name the objective

The control should prevent commitments that lack required preapproval.

Show the calculation

Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty.

Keep other rules visible

Below-threshold spending may still be subject to other restrictions.

Separate the decision

Who has authority to approve or reject the request?

Check timing

The evidence must show that required approval preceded the commitment.

Handle absence

Who covers the check when the usual operator is unavailable?

Route uncertainty

Send an unclear case to the designated policy reviewer.

Close accurately

The design can be assigned now; actual operation still needs verification.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Show the calculation
Useful wording: Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty.

Purpose: Separate trigger and decision
Useful wording: That amount requires review; it does not mean the event is approved.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which status statement is accurate?

A. H3 is published, but the control is not yet fully assigned or evidenced.

B. Publication proves every event has been checked.

C. A policy owner automatically performed all past checks.

D. The proposed meal is approved because its total is below $1,000.

2. Which event statement matches the rule?

A. The $120-per-guest proposal requires preapproval before commitment.

B. The $960 total may be divided into smaller claims to avoid review.

C. Eight guests make the threshold irrelevant.

D. Approval can be assumed because no booking exists yet.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The intended result of a control. Which term fits?

A. detective control

B. evidence repository

C. control objective

D. operating effectiveness

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The policy is published, but the check has no owner". Dinesh: "The estimate is nine hundred sixty dollars for eight guests, including all charges. Someone thought the total had to exceed a thousand." Mara: [missing response] Dinesh: "We can check the information on receipt, but my team should not be deciding whether the hospitality is permissible." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The threshold is per guest. Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty, so this proposal triggers compliance review. That calculation does not itself approve the event.

B. Define the issue escalation and cover arrangement. Urgency does not let the requester approve their own exception or split the event into smaller claims to make the threshold disappear.

C. H3 requires preapproval before commitment when the cost exceeds one hundred dollars per guest. An after-the-event receipt check can identify a problem, but it cannot replace that earlier requirement.

D. Correct. The approver is the designated compliance reviewer. Your team can perform the intake check and route it, while the reviewer decides under the actual policy and relevant requirements.

Answers and explanations, page 131

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The proposed meal is $960 divided by eight, or $120 per guest, so it exceeds the stated H3 threshold. That triggers review; it does not guarantee approval. Costs at or below $100 are not automatically acceptable because other restrictions still apply.

E Conversation

The policy is published, but the check has no owner

The policy is published, but the check has no owner

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

issue escalation / control operator / threshold / evidence repository / control evidence / approver / control trigger / design effectiveness / preapproval / Operating effectiveness

01 **Dinesh:** We uploaded H3 last month and emailed everyone. The dashboard says the policy rollout is complete. What else is missing?

02 **Mara:** Publication is complete, but the [1] _____ is not assigned. For the next hospitality request, we need to know who checks the amount, who makes the decision, and where the evidence goes.

03 **Dinesh:** We normally check receipts after the meal. For this one, nothing is booked. Where should our check sit before somebody commits the money?

04 **Mara:** H3 requires [2] _____ before commitment when the cost exceeds one hundred dollars per guest. An after-the-event receipt check can identify a problem, but it cannot replace that earlier requirement.

05 **Dinesh:** The estimate is nine hundred sixty dollars for eight guests, including all charges. Someone thought the total had to exceed a thousand.

06 **Mara:** The [3] _____ is per guest. Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty, so this proposal triggers compliance review. That calculation does not itself approve the event.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Dinesh:** We can check the information on receipt, but my team should not be deciding whether the hospitality is permissible.

08 **Mara:** Correct. The [4] _____ is the designated compliance reviewer. Your team can perform the intake check and route it, while the reviewer decides under the actual policy and relevant requirements.

09 **Dinesh:** What should the intake check record besides the amount? I want the evidence to be useful without collecting unnecessary information.

10 **Mara:** The [5] _____ should connect the request, purpose, relevant parties, cost calculation, decision, reviewer, and timing. Use the approved fields and handling rules, and retain what the process actually requires.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The policy is published, but the check has no owner

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Dinesh:** I found an approval in one mailbox and the estimate in another. We need to join those records before we can show what was actually approved.

12 **Mara:** We need an approved [6] _____ with the appropriate access and retention rules. A policy link does not show that a specific request was checked before commitment.

13 **Dinesh:** What happens if a requester says the booking cannot wait and the usual reviewer is unavailable?

14 **Mara:** Define the [7] _____ and cover arrangement. Urgency does not let the requester approve their own exception or split the event into smaller claims to make the threshold disappear.

15 **Dinesh:** Should every amount below one hundred dollars be marked approved automatically?

16 **Mara:** No. That would misread the [8] _____. The threshold governs this preapproval step, while other restrictions still apply at any amount. The procedure should preserve those checks rather than imply a universal permission.

17 **Dinesh:** Once we document these roles and test a sample request, can we say the control has always worked?

18 **Mara:** No. We can assess the [9] _____ of the defined process. A current walkthrough does not prove how earlier requests were handled or fill missing historical evidence.

The policy is published, but the check has no owner / continued

19 **Dinesh:** Then we should separate the completed publication task from the operational work still needed, and assign the expense check explicitly.

20 **Mara:** Exactly. [10] _____ needs evidence from actual operation. Let us record the operator, approver, cover route, and repository, then verify that the next requests follow the intended sequence.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. control operator / **2.** preapproval / **3.** threshold / **4.** approver / **5.** control evidence / **6.** evidence repository / **7.** issue escalation / **8.** control trigger / **9.** design effectiveness / **10.** Operating effectiveness

Why these answers fit, page 132

F Check accuracy and scope

The policy is published, but the check has no owner

Return to the case

Fictional company policy H3 requires compliance preapproval before committing to client hospitality costing more than $100 per guest, including all charges. Other restrictions still apply at any amount. H3 was published on 1 September, but the intake check and evidence retention have no assigned operator. A proposed meal costs $960 for eight guests, with no commitment yet made. Policy owner Mara and expense operations lead Dinesh must define who checks the request, who decides, where evidence is kept, and how exceptions are escalated. The event has not been approved.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which evidence is most useful?

A. The identified request, calculation, authorized decision, and timestamps showing the sequence

B. Only a link to the policy

C. An undated statement that staff generally follow rules

D. A receipt with no approval record or timing

2. What does a well-written procedure prove by itself?

A. Every future event will comply

B. All historical evidence exists

C. No exception can ever occur

D. The designed steps, not that they operated effectively in practice

Answers and explanations, page 134

Listen for the distinction

Correct the ten gaps. Distinguish the intake operator from the compliance approver and approval before commitment from checking a receipt afterward.

Published does not mean embedded in daily work

A team may believe compliance is complete because a document has been distributed. Ask how a real request moves through the process. Distinguish the person maintaining the policy from the person operating the check and the person making the approval decision.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Apply another fictional preapproval rule

Policy J2 requires review before commitment for hospitality above $80 per guest, including all charges. A proposed event costs $540 for six guests. Other restrictions still apply. No approval or booking is recorded.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

$90 / commitment / not approved / $80 threshold

01 **Coordinator:** The proposed cost per guest is [1] _____.

02 **Reviewer:** That exceeds the stated [2] _____.

03 **Coordinator:** Approval is required before [3] _____.

04 **Reviewer:** The current approval status is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. $90 / **2.** $80 threshold / **3.** commitment / **4.** not approved

Why these answers fit, page 134

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The policy is published, but the check has no owner". Dinesh: "What happens if a requester says the booking cannot wait and the usual reviewer is unavailable?" Mara: [missing response] Dinesh: "Should every amount below one hundred dollars be marked approved automatically?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. The approver is the designated compliance reviewer. Your team can perform the intake check and route it, while the reviewer decides under the actual policy and relevant requirements.

B. Define the issue escalation and cover arrangement. Urgency does not let the requester approve their own exception or split the event into smaller claims to make the threshold disappear.

C. H3 requires preapproval before commitment when the cost exceeds one hundred dollars per guest. An after-the-event receipt check can identify a problem, but it cannot replace that earlier requirement.

D. The threshold is per guest. Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty, so this proposal triggers compliance review. That calculation does not itself approve the event.

Answers and explanations, page 135

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Contract Intake and Workflow" and "Policy Implementation and Controls". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Assessing a request to determine its route, priority, and next action. Which term fits?

A. unsigned proposal
B. agreement type
C. routing rule
D. triage

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A control intended to stop an unwanted event before it occurs. Which term fits?

A. commitment
B. policy
C. preventive control
D. segregation of duties

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction". Ben: "Nell needs a decision about whether to proceed by the sixth of October at noon UTC. She hopes to sign by the ninth." Mina: [missing response] Ben: "The pilot will use customer contact details. I am not sure whether the supplier only views them or also stores a copy." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Thank you. The NDA and the pilot services arrangement have different purposes. We need the current proposal and any referenced service terms, rather than treat the earlier confidentiality document as approval of the whole purchase.
B. Include that uncertainty in the review scope. The data flow and access details may affect which specialists need to review. Please do not answer stored or not stored merely to make the form look complete.
C. I cannot give that turnaround estimate yet. I can acknowledge receipt and confirm that we are clarifying the route. Once the scope and reviewer availability are known, we can communicate a supported timing expectation.
D. That gives us a specific decision deadline and a separate target signature date. I will record both and the business consequence of delay, but those dates do not establish reviewer availability or approval.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The policy is published, but the check has no owner". Dinesh: "Once we document these roles and test a sample request, can we say the control has always worked?" Mara: [missing response] Dinesh: "Then we should separate the completed publication task from the operational work still needed, and assign the expense check explicitly." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. H3 requires preapproval before commitment when the cost exceeds one hundred dollars per guest. An after-the-event receipt check can identify a problem, but it cannot replace that earlier requirement.

B. Exactly. Operating effectiveness needs evidence from actual operation. Let us record the operator, approver, cover route, and repository, then verify that the next requests follow the intended sequence.

C. We need an approved evidence repository with the appropriate access and retention rules. A policy link does not show that a specific request was checked before commitment.

D. No. We can assess the design effectiveness of the defined process. A current walkthrough does not prove how earlier requests were handled or fill missing historical evidence.

Answers and explanations, page 166

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / COMPLIANCE AUDITS AND EVIDENCE

Respond to an evidence request with the correct period, source, completeness, and limitations.

> **A current screenshot does not answer a historical question**
>
> Auditor Talia requests evidence of monthly privileged-access reviews for January through March 2026. Record owner Hugo locates the January and February review packages but has not found March. A colleague suggests sending a screenshot taken on 2 April showing the current access-review setting. The screenshot does not establish whether the three monthly reviews occurred. Hugo must identify the records found, disclose the March evidence gap, and continue the authorized search. He must not backdate a new record or assert that the missing package proves the March review never happened.

People: Talia, Compliance auditor; Hugo, Control record owner.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which period did Talia request?

A. Only 2 April 2026
B. Every month after April
C. An unspecified current day
D. January through March 2026

2. Which review packages have been found?

A. None of the requested records
B. January and February
C. All three requested months
D. Only March

3. What does the April screenshot establish by itself?

A. Proof of every January-to-March review
B. Proof that March was never reviewed
C. A replacement original March sign-off
D. The displayed current setting, not completion of all three historical reviews

Answers and explanations, page 136

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

audit scope
The subjects, boundaries, and period included in an audit.

confirm the audit scope

PBC list
Prepared-by-client list; an auditor's requested information schedule in relevant practice.

maintain the PBC list

population
The complete defined set of items relevant to a test.

establish the population

privileged access
Access with elevated permissions under the relevant system rules.

review privileged access

source record
The originating record used as evidence.

preserve source records

timestamp
A recorded date and time for an event.

verify timestamps

evidence request
A request for records supporting a specified question or assessment.

clarify the evidence request

review period
The time interval covered by an assessment.

state the review period

sample
Selected items examined from a defined population.

explain the sample

review package
The linked records supporting a particular review.

assemble the review package

provenance
Information about the origin and history of an item.

document evidence provenance

metadata
Information describing a record, such as origin, dates, and version.

retain relevant metadata

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

audit scope AUDIT SCOPE

confirm the audit scope

Keep the meaning precise: The subjects, boundaries, and period included in an audit.

sample SAMPLE

explain the sample

Keep the meaning precise: Selected items examined from a defined population.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

contemporaneous evidence

Evidence created at or near the event it records.

locate contemporaneous evidence

completeness

Whether all required or relevant items are included on the stated basis.

assess completeness

relevance

The connection between evidence and the question being assessed.

assess evidence relevance

exception log

A record of identified departures and their handling.

reconcile the exception log

reperformance

Independently carrying out a procedure to check its result.

document reperformance

audit trail

A traceable record of actions, changes, and decisions.

preserve the audit trail

retrospective account

A later description of an earlier event.

label a retrospective account

reliability

The extent to which information can be depended on for the intended purpose.

assess evidence reliability

evidence gap

Missing information needed to support an assessment.

disclose an evidence gap

sign-off

A recorded approval or confirmation under the relevant process.

verify reviewer sign-off

redaction

Removal or obscuring of information for an authorized disclosure purpose.

document necessary redactions

management response

Management's factual reply and planned actions concerning an audit matter.

prepare the management response

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

metadata METADATA

retain relevant metadata

Keep the meaning precise: Information describing a record, such as origin, dates, and version.

relevance RELEVANCE

assess evidence relevance

Keep the meaning precise: The connection between evidence and the question being assessed.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Confirm the scope

You are requesting the monthly reviews for January through March 2026.

Disclose the gap

We have not yet located the March package.

Describe the screenshot

This image was taken on the second of April and shows the current setting.

Identify the source

Each package will show its originating system, reviewer, and relevant dates.

Preserve the record

We will retain the original files and relevant metadata.

Handle sensitive content

Use approved access and redaction procedures without concealing relevant gaps.

Clarify alternatives

Would these separately identified records help assess the missing period?

Agree a follow-up

I will provide the search status and any additional records by the agreed date.

State what is available

We have located the January and February packages.

Limit the conclusion

That gap does not by itself establish whether the review occurred.

Separate configuration from operation

It does not demonstrate completion of the three monthly reviews.

Check completeness

Let us reconcile the requested months against the evidence index.

Avoid backdating

Any later explanation will carry its actual creation date.

Continue the search

We will check the authorized repositories and record the search result.

Keep the limitation visible

Alternative evidence must be described for what it actually proves.

Close accurately

The submission covers two located packages and an explicit March evidence gap.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Limit the conclusion
Useful wording: That gap does not by itself establish whether the review occurred.

Purpose: Describe the screenshot
Useful wording: This image was taken on the second of April and shows the current setting.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which submission description is accurate?

A. A new March sign-off can be dated earlier to complete the file.

B. January and February packages are available; March remains an identified evidence gap.

C. All three months are complete because the current setting is enabled.

D. March definitely failed because the package is not yet found.

2. Which question best tests the screenshot's relevance?

A. Does the screenshot's existence establish completeness of the quarterly submission?

B. Does this current setting image show that the requested historical reviews actually occurred?

C. Does the current setting prove the same setting existed throughout the quarter?

D. Can today's enabled status stand in for each monthly reviewer sign-off?

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The time interval covered by an assessment. Which term fits?

A. review period

B. completeness

C. reperformance

D. source record

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A current screenshot does not answer a historical question". Talia: "That distinction matters. I need evidence of operation during the requested months, not only evidence that a review feature is currently enabled." Hugo: [missing response] Talia: "What is included in the two packages you have located? We need to understand how they connect to the control activity." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will call it an evidence gap. It means we cannot presently support the activity with that package, not that we have established the review never happened.

B. I am reconciling completeness against that list. It will show two located packages and one missing package, with any further evidence added under its own source and date.

C. The timestamp is the second of April. It shows the setting visible then. It does not establish that each January-to-March review was performed or signed off.

D. Understood. The review period remains January through March 2026. I will label the April image separately so it cannot be mistaken for a historical review record.

Answers and explanations, page 136

One useful distinction

Two located packages out of three requested months is a statement about evidence availability. It is not automatically a 66.7% control-effectiveness score. The March gap must be disclosed while the underlying activity and available alternative evidence are assessed.

E Conversation

A current screenshot does not answer a historical question

A current screenshot does not answer a historical question

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

review packages / evidence gap / management response / source record / timestamp / audit trail / redactions / completeness / retrospective account / review period

01 **Talia:** The request covers monthly privileged-access reviews for January through March. Can you confirm which records your submission will include?

02 **Hugo:** We have located the January and February [1] _____. I have not found March yet, so I will identify that gap rather than describe the quarter as fully documented.

03 **Talia:** I also have a screenshot marked review enabled. When was it taken? I do not want to mistake a current setting for a completed monthly check.

04 **Hugo:** The [2] _____ is the second of April. It shows the setting visible then. It does not establish that each January-to-March review was performed or signed off.

05 **Talia:** That distinction matters. I need evidence of operation during the requested months, not only evidence that a review feature is currently enabled.

06 **Hugo:** Understood. The [3] _____ remains January through March 2026. I will label the April image separately so it cannot be mistaken for a historical review record.

07 **Talia:** What is included in the two packages you have located? We need to understand how they connect to the control activity.

08 **Hugo:** Each should identify the [4] _____, relevant user population, reviewer, date, decision, and exceptions. I will verify those contents rather than assume a file titled completed review contains every required element.

09 **Talia:** Do you have an index showing the requested months and the status of each item?

10 **Hugo:** I am reconciling [5] _____ against that list. It will show two located packages and one missing package, with any further evidence added under its own source and date.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A current screenshot does not answer a historical question

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Talia:** Please be careful not to turn the missing March package into an unsupported conclusion about whether the review occurred.

12 **Hugo:** I will call it an [6] _____. It means we cannot presently support the activity with that package, not that we have established the review never happened.

13 **Talia:** If the reviewer remembers doing it, send that account too. Just keep its actual date visible; it cannot become the missing March sign-off.

14 **Hugo:** Any [7] _____ will have its actual creation date and author. We will not recreate a sign-off and date it in March merely to make the index look complete.

15 **Talia:** Some records contain user details. Follow the approved sharing process, but make clear if any removal limits what I can assess.

16 **Hugo:** We will document necessary [8] _____ and use the authorized access route. We should not conceal a relevant exception or missing field under a general statement that the package was cleaned up.

17 **Talia:** What will you do next to locate the missing material or determine what other evidence exists?

18 **Hugo:** I will check the authorized repositories and preserve the [9] _____ of what we find. Any alternative records will be identified separately, with an explanation of what they show and what they do not.

19 **Talia:** Then send the two packages, the index, and the search status by the agreed follow-up date. Keep the March limitation visible.

20 **Hugo:** I will make that clear in the [10] _____. The response will distinguish current configuration, the two located monthly reviews, and the outstanding March evidence question, without backdating records or inventing an effectiveness score.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. review packages / **2.** timestamp / **3.** review period / **4.** source record / **5.** completeness / **6.** evidence gap / **7.** retrospective account / **8.** redactions / **9.** audit trail / **10.** management response

Why these answers fit, page 137

F Check accuracy and scope

A current screenshot does not answer a historical question

Return to the case

Auditor Talia requests evidence of monthly privileged-access reviews for January through March 2026. Record owner Hugo locates the January and February review packages but has not found March. A colleague suggests sending a screenshot taken on 2 April showing the current access-review setting. The screenshot does not establish whether the three monthly reviews occurred. Hugo must identify the records found, disclose the March evidence gap, and continue the authorized search. He must not backdate a new record or assert that the missing package proves the March review never happened.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. How should a later employee explanation be handled?

A. Backdate it to the month being discussed.

B. Discard all later information without considering relevance.

C. Label its source and actual date and assess what it supports.

D. Treat it automatically as the missing original sign-off.

2. What does two packages out of three establish?

A. A universal 66.7% compliance rating

B. Proof that every user was correctly authorized

C. Proof that March access was improper

D. Current evidence availability for two requested months

Answers and explanations, page 139

Listen for the distinction

Correct the ten gaps. Explain why two located packages establish availability, not a 66.7% effectiveness score.

An evidence gap needs a precise answer

Audit questions can feel accusatory when teams are busy. Treat the requested period and record type as shared criteria. Acknowledge what is missing without becoming defensive, inventing evidence, or making a broader conclusion than the records support.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Describe another incomplete evidence submission

An auditor requests April, May, and June review packages. April and May are located; June is not. A screenshot dated 3 July shows the current setting. The underlying June activity remains unverified.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

nonperformance / 3 July / April through June / June

01 **Owner:** The requested period is [1] _____.

02 **Auditor:** The missing package is [2] _____.

03 **Owner:** The screenshot date is [3] _____.

04 **Auditor:** The gap alone does not prove [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. April through June / **2.** June / **3.** 3 July / **4.** nonperformance

Why these answers fit, page 139

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A current screenshot does not answer a historical question". Talia: "If the reviewer remembers doing it, send that account too. Just keep its actual date visible; it cannot become the missing March sign-off." Hugo: [missing response] Talia: "Some records contain user details. Follow the approved sharing process, but make clear if any removal limits what I can assess." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Each should identify the source record, relevant user population, reviewer, date, decision, and exceptions. I will verify those contents rather than assume a file titled completed review contains every required element.

B. Any retrospective account will have its actual creation date and author. We will not recreate a sign-off and date it in March merely to make the index look complete.

C. We have located the January and February review packages. I have not found March yet, so I will identify that gap rather than describe the quarter as fully documented.

D. I am reconciling completeness against that list. It will show two located packages and one missing package, with any further evidence added under its own source and date.

Answers and explanations, page 140

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / INTERNAL INVESTIGATIONS

Attribute reported events, separate inference from observation, and route sensitive concerns for impartial review.

> **Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding**
>
> Reporter Elena says that on 27 September she saw invoice V19 marked approved while its receiving field was blank. She interprets this as evidence that her manager took a payoff, but she did not see a payment to the manager. The records and transaction context have not been reviewed. Intake coordinator Noah must preserve the allegation and its source without recording the suspected motive as fact. Elena fears adverse shift changes if her manager learns of the report. The fictional process requires restricted handling, preservation referral, and assignment to an appropriate reviewer without a conflict.

People: Elena, Employee making a report; Noah, Compliance intake coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What does Elena say she observed?

A. V19 marked approved while the receiving field was blank
B. A payment made directly to the manager
C. A completed investigation finding
D. A confession by the supplier

2. What is the current status of the suspected motive?

A. Proof that the report must be false
B. An allegation or inference that has not been established
C. A verified fact because Elena is concerned
D. A formal finding of misconduct

3. What additional concern requires recording?

A. The manager has already been found guilty.
B. All records may now be deleted.
C. Elena fears adverse shift changes after reporting.
D. Elena has approved the transaction.

Answers and explanations, page 141

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

allegation
A claim that something occurred, not necessarily established as fact.

record an allegation

inference
A conclusion drawn from information rather than directly observed.

distinguish an inference

reporter
A person raising a concern through a relevant route.

acknowledge the reporter

witness
A person who may provide relevant observations or information.

identify potential witnesses

contradictory evidence
Information that conflicts with a claim or interpretation.

assess contradictory evidence

first-hand account
Information described by someone who directly experienced the event.

distinguish a first-hand account

reported observation
An event or condition a person says they directly perceived.

attribute a reported observation

finding
A conclusion reached through an authorized assessment of evidence.

substantiate a finding

subject
The person or matter being examined in an investigation.

identify the investigation subject

corroboration
Additional evidence supporting an account or claim.

seek corroboration

chronology
A time-ordered account of relevant events.

establish a chronology

hearsay
Information received from another person, with legal treatment depending on context.

attribute second-hand information

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

allegation ALLEGATION

record an allegation

Keep the meaning precise: A claim that something occurred, not necessarily established as fact.

subject SUBJECT

identify the investigation subject

Keep the meaning precise: The person or matter being examined in an investigation.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

intake note

The initial record of a reported concern and its source.

prepare a neutral intake note

investigation scope

The defined questions and boundaries of an inquiry.

establish investigation scope

independence

Freedom from inappropriate influence in the relevant assessment.

protect reviewer independence

confidentiality

Controlled handling of information under applicable duties and limits.

explain confidentiality limits

retaliation concern

A concern about adverse treatment because of reporting or another protected activity.

record a retaliation concern

legal hold

A direction to preserve specified information for a legal matter under applicable requirements.

follow a legal hold

case handoff

Transfer of the relevant information and responsibility to the next authorized role.

document the case handoff

conflict of interest

A competing interest that may impair or appear to impair impartial judgment.

disclose a conflict of interest

need-to-know access

Access limited to people requiring information for an authorized purpose.

restrict access on a need-to-know basis

anonymity

A person's identity being unknown or withheld in a specified context.

distinguish anonymity

preservation

Keeping relevant information from being improperly lost or altered.

refer preservation needs

factual attribution

Identifying who said or supplied a statement and its evidential status.

maintain factual attribution

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

hearsay HEARSAY

attribute second-hand information

Keep the meaning precise: Information received from another person, with legal treatment depending on context.

independence INDEPENDENCE

protect reviewer independence

Keep the meaning precise: Freedom from inappropriate influence in the relevant assessment.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the report

Thank you for raising the concern; I will record what you tell me accurately.

Ask about observation

What did you personally see or hear?

Separate interpretation

Which part is your conclusion about what the event meant?

Attribute the statement

You report seeing V19 marked approved with a blank receiving field.

Avoid a premature finding

The suspected payoff has not been established.

Clarify timing

When did you see the status, and which record was it?

Keep the context open

We need the transaction context before concluding why the field was blank.

Record uncertainty

I will mark that detail as unknown rather than fill it in.

Preserve relevant material

Do not alter or delete relevant records; follow the authorized preservation instructions.

Avoid unauthorized collection

Do not access another person's account or gather material outside your permission.

Explain handling

Information will be shared only through the authorized process with appropriate people.

Avoid absolute secrecy

I cannot promise that no one else will need to know.

Check impartiality

The reviewer must not have a conflict concerning the allegation.

Record a separate concern

I will record your concern about possible shift changes separately.

Avoid promising an outcome

I cannot predict the review result or any disciplinary decision.

Close the handoff

I will route the factual record and the additional concern to the appropriate reviewer.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Attribute the statement
Useful wording: You report seeing V19 marked approved with a blank receiving field.

Purpose: Avoid a premature finding
Useful wording: The suspected payoff has not been established.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which intake sentence is neutral and useful?

A. Elena has no concern because she cannot prove a payment.

B. A blank receiving field establishes that no goods arrived.

C. Elena reports seeing V19 approved with a blank receiving field and suspects a payoff.

D. The manager took a payoff and falsified every invoice.

2. What should a reviewer do with alternative explanations?

A. Assess relevant supporting and contradictory evidence under the authorized scope.

B. Ignore them after the allegation is recorded.

C. Treat them as proof the reporter lied.

D. Ask the reporter to investigate secretly.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A conclusion reached through an authorized assessment of evidence. Which term fits?

A. investigation scope

B. finding

C. retaliation concern

D. contradictory evidence

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding". Elena: "I read the empty field as goods not received. That was my assumption; I did not check with receiving." Noah: [missing response] Elena: "A colleague may have seen the same screen. Should I ask them to agree with my account before you take it further?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Thank you for raising it. I will separate your reported observation from your interpretation. You saw the approved status and blank field. Did you personally see any payment to the manager?

B. I will refer the preservation needs to the appropriate team. Keep relevant material intact and follow their instructions. Do not enter another person's account or collect information outside your permissions.

C. No. Possible corroboration should be assessed through the authorized review. You can identify a potential witness, but do not coach an account or ask someone to confirm details they did not observe.

D. That is an inference we should identify. A blank field may need explanation, but it does not by itself establish nonreceipt, improper approval, or a payment to your manager.

Answers and explanations, page 141

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The intake note should say Elena reports seeing an approved status and a blank receiving field. A blank field does not establish that goods were never received, that approval was improper, or that a payoff occurred. Those are separate questions for review.

E Conversation

Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding

Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

corroboration / conflict of interest / confidentiality / inference / case handoff / preservation / allegation / retaliation concern / chronology / reported observation

01 **Elena:** I saw V19 marked approved on the twenty-seventh of September, but the receiving field was blank. I think my manager is getting a payoff.

02 **Noah:** Thank you for raising it. I will separate your [1] _____ from your interpretation. You saw the approved status and blank field. Did you personally see any payment to the manager?

03 **Elena:** No. The timing looked suspicious to me, but I did not see money change hands or a payment record.

04 **Noah:** I will record the payoff as an [2] _____, not an established fact. You do not need to prove the entire concern before we receive it, but the note must be accurate about what you know.

05 **Elena:** I read the empty field as goods not received. That was my assumption; I did not check with receiving.

06 **Noah:** That is an [3] _____ we should identify. A blank field may need explanation, but it does not by itself establish nonreceipt, improper approval, or a payment to your manager.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Elena:** A colleague may have seen the same screen. Should I ask them to agree with my account before you take it further?

08 **Noah:** No. Possible [4] _____ should be assessed through the authorized review. You can identify a potential witness, but do not coach an account or ask someone to confirm details they did not observe.

09 **Elena:** I remember the date clearly, although I would need to check my notes for the time. I do not want to guess.

10 **Noah:** Keep that distinction in the [5] _____. We can record the date you recall and mark the time as unconfirmed. The reviewer can assess relevant records and context rather than rely on invented precision.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Elena:** I have my own notes and a message about the invoice. I have not changed them or accessed anyone else's account.

12 **Noah:** I will refer the [6] _____ needs to the appropriate team. Keep relevant material intact and follow their instructions. Do not enter another person's account or collect information outside your permissions.

13 **Elena:** Can you guarantee that my manager will never learn that I contacted you? I am worried about how this could affect my work.

14 **Noah:** I can explain our [7] _____ process, but I cannot promise absolute secrecy. Information needs controlled handling by the appropriate people, and some details may need to be shared for a fair review.

15 **Elena:** The manager is close to someone on the usual review team. I am concerned that the report could go straight back to them.

16 **Noah:** We should record the possible [8] _____. The assignment needs an appropriate reviewer without a conflict. I will not ask the person implicated in the report to decide whether the concern may be reviewed.

17 **Elena:** I have not had my shifts changed yet, but I fear that could happen if the manager thinks I complained.

18 **Noah:** I will record that [9] _____ separately and route it promptly under the relevant process. Please distinguish any later event from the fear you are describing now, and use the designated contact if something changes.

19 **Elena:** Please read it back. I want the invoice checked; I never said I saw a payment.

20 **Noah:** The [10] _____ will distinguish your observation, suspected motive, unknown context, and separate concern. We cannot promise a finding or outcome.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. reported observation / **2.** allegation / **3.** inference / **4.** corroboration / **5.** chronology / **6.** preservation / **7.** confidentiality / **8.** conflict of interest / **9.** retaliation concern / **10.** case handoff

Why these answers fit, page 142

F Check accuracy and scope

Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding

Return to the case

Reporter Elena says that on 27 September she saw invoice V19 marked approved while its receiving field was blank. She interprets this as evidence that her manager took a payoff, but she did not see a payment to the manager. The records and transaction context have not been reviewed. Intake coordinator Noah must preserve the allegation and its source without recording the suspected motive as fact. Elena fears adverse shift changes if her manager learns of the report. The fictional process requires restricted handling, preservation referral, and assignment to an appropriate reviewer without a conflict.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which confidentiality statement is appropriate?

A. Nobody else will ever see any information.

B. Every report is automatically legally privileged.

C. All colleagues may receive the full report to offer opinions.

D. The report will follow restricted authorized handling, but absolute secrecy cannot be promised.

2. How should the shift concern be handled?

A. Promise no adverse action can ever occur.

B. Omit it because no shift change has yet happened.

C. Ask the implicated manager alone to decide whether the report may continue.

D. Record it as a separate concern and route it through the appropriate process.

Answers and explanations, page 144

Listen for the distinction

Correct the ten gaps. Reread the witness, uncertain-time, and preservation exchanges without coaching evidence or guessing details.

Neutral wording is not disbelief

Attributing a statement protects the usefulness of the record; it does not mean the concern is unimportant. Explain that the review must distinguish what the reporter observed, what they inferred, and what the relevant evidence establishes. Do not demand that a reporter prove the entire case before accepting it.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Keep another allegation accurately attributed

Rosa says she saw a supplier invoice marked paid before its delivery field was completed. She suspects a personal benefit to the approver but saw no such payment. The transaction context is unreviewed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

nondelivery / allegation / unreviewed / reported observation

01 **Coordinator:** Rosa's account of the screen is a [1] _____.

02 **Reporter:** The suspected personal benefit is an [2] _____.

03 **Coordinator:** The blank field does not prove [3] _____.

04 **Reporter:** The transaction context remains [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. reported observation / **2.** allegation / **3.** nondelivery / **4.** unreviewed

Why these answers fit, page 144

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding". Elena: "Can you guarantee that my manager will never learn that I contacted you? I am worried about how this could affect my work." Noah: [missing response] Elena: "The manager is close to someone on the usual review team. I am concerned that the report could go straight back to them." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No. Possible corroboration should be assessed through the authorized review. You can identify a potential witness, but do not coach an account or ask someone to confirm details they did not observe.

B. Keep that distinction in the chronology. We can record the date you recall and mark the time as unconfirmed. The reviewer can assess relevant records and context rather than rely on invented precision.

C. I can explain our confidentiality process, but I cannot promise absolute secrecy. Information needs controlled handling by the appropriate people, and some details may need to be shared for a fair review.

D. Thank you for raising it. I will separate your reported observation from your interpretation. You saw the approved status and blank field. Did you personally see any payment to the manager?

Answers and explanations, page 145

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Compliance Audits and Evidence" and "Internal Investigations". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Prepared-by-client list; an auditor's requested information schedule in relevant practice. Which term fits?

A. sign-off
B. retrospective account
C. review package
D. PBC list

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Additional evidence supporting an account or claim. Which term fits?

A. corroboration
B. intake note
C. allegation
D. confidentiality

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The policy is published, but the check has no owner". Dinesh: "What should the intake check record besides the amount? I want the evidence to be useful without collecting unnecessary information." Mara: [missing response] Dinesh: "I found an approval in one mailbox and the estimate in another. We need to join those records before we can show what was actually approved." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The control evidence should connect the request, purpose, relevant parties, cost calculation, decision, reviewer, and timing. Use the approved fields and handling rules, and retain what the process actually requires.
B. H3 requires preapproval before commitment when the cost exceeds one hundred dollars per guest. An after-the-event receipt check can identify a problem, but it cannot replace that earlier requirement.
C. Correct. The approver is the designated compliance reviewer. Your team can perform the intake check and route it, while the reviewer decides under the actual policy and relevant requirements.
D. The threshold is per guest. Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty, so this proposal triggers compliance review. That calculation does not itself approve the event.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding". Elena: "I have not had my shifts changed yet, but I fear that could happen if the manager thinks I complained." Noah: [missing response] Elena: "Please read it back. I want the invoice checked; I never said I saw a payment." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will record the payoff as an allegation, not an established fact. You do not need to prove the entire concern before we receive it, but the note must be accurate about what you know.

B. Keep that distinction in the chronology. We can record the date you recall and mark the time as unconfirmed. The reviewer can assess relevant records and context rather than rely on invented precision.

C. We should record the possible conflict of interest. The assignment needs an appropriate reviewer without a conflict. I will not ask the person implicated in the report to decide whether the concern may be reviewed.

D. I will record that retaliation concern separately and route it promptly under the relevant process. Please distinguish any later event from the fear you are describing now, and use the designated contact if something changes.

Answers and explanations, page 169

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / PRIVACY OPERATIONS AND DATA REQUESTS

Clarify identity and requested actions, preserve receipt details, and route timing and disclosure decisions correctly.

Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record

At 09:00 UTC on 1 October, agent Pia receives a message from an unfamiliar address signed A. Lee: Send me what you hold about me and delete my contact details. The message lacks enough information to match the person securely to an account. Privacy coordinator Wen must log the original wording and receipt time, arrange proportionate identity clarification through the approved route, and distinguish access from deletion. Applicable law, response timing, and any retention constraints need specialist confirmation. Staff must not disclose a guessed account, demand unnecessary documents, or promise automatic deletion.

People: Pia, Customer service agent; Wen, Privacy operations coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What two actions does the message request?

A. A confirmed transfer of every account to a third party
B. Access to information and deletion of contact details
C. Only a password reset
D. Only a marketing quote

2. Why is identity clarification needed here?

A. Every request must always include a passport.
B. Poorly phrased English invalidates all requests.
C. Staff are entitled to postpone any inconvenient message indefinitely.
D. The unfamiliar address and name do not securely identify the relevant account.

3. What should be preserved at intake?

A. A rewritten deletion-only request
B. A guessed account number reported as confirmed
C. The original wording and 1 October 09:00 UTC receipt time
D. Only the date a specialist eventually opens the record

Answers and explanations, page 146

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

data subject
A person to whom personal information relates in relevant data-protection frameworks.

identify the data subject

personal data
Information relating to an identified or identifiable person under applicable law.

identify personal data

SAR
Subject access request; a request to exercise the relevant right of access.

recognize a SAR

DSAR
Data subject access request; another common term for a personal-data access request.

route a DSAR

right of access
A legally defined right to obtain personal information and related information, subject to applicable rules.

assess a right-of-access request

erasure request
A request to delete personal information under the relevant rules.

assess an erasure request

rectification
Correction of inaccurate or incomplete personal information under applicable rules.

route a rectification request

identity verification
Proportionate checking that the person is who they claim to be.

complete identity verification

authorized representative
A person whose authority to act for another has been established.

verify representative authority

request scope
The information or actions covered by a request.

clarify request scope

clarification
Information sought to resolve a relevant uncertainty.

request necessary clarification

proportionality
Matching the extent of an action to its legitimate need and context.

assess proportionality

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

data subject DATA SUBJECT

identify the data subject

Keep the meaning precise: A person to whom personal information relates in relevant data-protection frameworks.

erasure request ERASURE REQUEST

assess an erasure request

Keep the meaning precise: A request to delete personal information under the relevant rules.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

data minimization

Limiting information use or collection to what is necessary for the relevant purpose.

apply data minimization

receipt timestamp

The recorded date and time the request arrived.

preserve the receipt timestamp

response deadline

The due date determined under the applicable rules and facts.

verify the response deadline

jurisdiction

The legal system or authority relevant to the matter.

confirm the applicable jurisdiction

controller

A role determining processing purposes and means under relevant data-protection law.

identify the controller role

processor

A role processing personal data on behalf of a controller under relevant law.

assess the processor role

search scope

The defined systems, records, and criteria covered by a search.

document the search scope

third-party information

Information relating to someone other than the requester.

review third-party information

exemption

A legally applicable qualification or exception requiring case-specific assessment.

assess an exemption

retention obligation

A duty to keep specified information under applicable requirements.

verify retention obligations

secure disclosure

Providing information through an appropriately protected, authorized method.

arrange secure disclosure

request log

A record of requests, actions, status, and relevant dates.

maintain the request log

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

proportionality PROPORTIONALITY

assess proportionality

Keep the meaning precise: Matching the extent of an action to its legitimate need and context.

controller CONTROLLER

identify the controller role

Keep the meaning precise: A role determining processing purposes and means under relevant data-protection law.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Recognize the substance

The message asks for access and deletion, even though it uses ordinary language.

Keep the wording

Retain the original message as well as the operational summary.

Avoid disclosure by guess

Do not confirm or send a guessed account's information.

Explain the purpose

The clarification helps us avoid disclosing your information to the wrong person.

Avoid a false promise

We cannot promise that every record will be deleted automatically.

Keep the clock visible

Continue tracking dates unless the authorized assessment establishes a permitted change.

Protect other people

Any third-party information requires the appropriate review.

Use an appropriate delivery route

Disclosure must follow the approved secure method after the required checks.

Preserve receipt

Record the first of October at zero nine hundred UTC.

State the uncertainty

We cannot yet match the sender securely to an account.

Ask proportionately

Use the approved route to request only the information needed to resolve identity.

Separate the actions

Access and deletion need distinct assessment within the request.

Check the governing rules

The privacy team needs to confirm applicable law and response timing.

Clarify without coercion

Do not force a narrower request merely to reduce the search.

Verify authority

If a representative is acting, confirm their authority through the proper process.

Close the handoff

Log the request, the uncertainty, the assigned owner, and the next action.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the uncertainty
Useful wording: We cannot yet match the sender securely to an account.

Purpose: Avoid disclosure by guess
Useful wording: Do not confirm or send a guessed account's information.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which initial response is appropriate?

A. Log both requested actions and arrange necessary identity clarification through the approved route.

B. Send the closest matching account immediately.

C. Reject the request because it does not say DSAR.

D. Delete all records before checking identity or retention duties.

2. Which identity approach is proportionate?

A. Request only information needed to resolve the actual uncertainty under the approved process.

B. Require a passport for every requester because one case needed it.

C. Treat the nearest matching name as verified if only one account is active.

D. Collect additional documents for possible future questions before assessing this uncertainty.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Data subject access request; another common term for a personal-data access request. Which term fits?

A. response deadline

B. DSAR

C. exemption

D. authorized representative

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record". Pia: "Our last case used a passport. Should I ask for one again, or first check what would resolve this particular account match?" Wen: [missing response] Pia: "I can explain that we need enough information to avoid sending somebody else's record. Should I ask the person to choose access or deletion?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Use data minimization. Request only what is necessary under the approved process to resolve the uncertainty. Formal identification is not automatically the right answer in every case, and unnecessary documents create their own handling risk.

B. Record the receipt timestamp and keep the original wording. It contains an access request and a deletion request, even though the person has not used our internal terminology or a legal label.

C. No. An erasure request has its own assessment. Applicable requirements and retention constraints may affect the outcome. We should not promise deletion before the responsible team has reviewed what the request covers.

D. Do not assume that about the response deadline. Record the action and continue tracking dates unless the authorized assessment establishes the relevant timing treatment. An internal transfer is not permission to lose the original receipt date.

Answers and explanations, page 146

One useful distinction

The message contains two distinct requested actions. Recognizing an access or deletion request does not establish identity, disclosure scope, or the outcome of a deletion assessment. Preserve the original wording and avoid silently narrowing the request to make processing easier.

E Conversation

Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record

Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

receipt timestamp / erasure request / third-party information / data minimization / request scope / identity verification / jurisdiction / response deadline / request log / authorized representative

01 **Pia:** This message came in at zero nine hundred UTC on the first of October. It says send me what you hold about me and delete my contact details.

02 **Wen:** Record the [1] _____ and keep the original wording. It contains an access request and a deletion request, even though the person has not used our internal terminology or a legal label.

03 **Pia:** The address is unfamiliar and the signature is only A. Lee. Several accounts could match that name.

04 **Wen:** Then [2] _____ needs attention through the approved route. Do not choose the nearest account or confirm its details to this sender while the match is uncertain.

05 **Pia:** Our last case used a passport. Should I ask for one again, or first check what would resolve this particular account match?

06 **Wen:** Use [3] _____. Request only what is necessary under the approved process to resolve the uncertainty. Formal identification is not automatically the right answer in every case, and unnecessary documents create their own handling risk.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Pia:** I can explain that we need enough information to avoid sending somebody else's record. Should I ask the person to choose access or deletion?

08 **Wen:** Keep both parts of the [4] _____. We may need necessary clarification, but we should not make them abandon one action because our queue is easier to manage that way.

09 **Pia:** Could we complete the access part and promise that every matching record will then be deleted?

10 **Wen:** No. An [5] _____ has its own assessment. Applicable requirements and retention constraints may affect the outcome. We should not promise deletion before the responsible team has reviewed what the request covers.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Pia:** I have seen a one-month deadline in training material. Does that automatically apply to every request our global team receives?

12 **Wen:** We need to confirm the applicable [6] _____ and rules with the privacy team. A remembered example is not a universal rule for every person, organization, or requested action.

13 **Pia:** The system has a pause button for clarification. Should I use it now, or does the privacy team need to confirm the timing rule first?

14 **Wen:** Do not assume that about the [7] _____. Record the action and continue tracking dates unless the authorized assessment establishes the relevant timing treatment. An internal transfer is not permission to lose the original receipt date.

15 **Pia:** The person may ask a family member to respond for them. How would that change the next step?

16 **Wen:** We would need to establish an [8] _____ through the proper process. A family relationship alone should not be treated as automatically proving authority to receive another person's information.

17 **Pia:** Once identity and scope are clear, the records may include messages involving colleagues or other customers.

18 **Wen:** Flag [9] _____ for the appropriate review. The access request does not mean we can send an unreviewed export containing everybody else's details.

19 **Pia:** I will log the combined request, the identity uncertainty, and the referral to the privacy team without making an outcome promise.

20 **Wen:** Good. Keep the [10] _____ complete with the owner and next action. Then use the approved verification, assessment, and secure-response process while preserving what the person actually requested.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. receipt timestamp / **2.** identity verification / **3.** data minimization / **4.** request scope / **5.** erasure request / **6.** jurisdiction / **7.** response deadline / **8.** authorized representative / **9.** third-party information / **10.** request log

Why these answers fit, page 148

F Check accuracy and scope

Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record

Return to the case

At 09:00 UTC on 1 October, agent Pia receives a message from an unfamiliar address signed A. Lee: Send me what you hold about me and delete my contact details. The message lacks enough information to match the person securely to an account. Privacy coordinator Wen must log the original wording and receipt time, arrange proportionate identity clarification through the approved route, and distinguish access from deletion. Applicable law, response timing, and any retention constraints need specialist confirmation. Staff must not disclose a guessed account, demand unnecessary documents, or promise automatic deletion.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which timing statement is accurate for this case?

A. A receipt timestamp is unnecessary if identity is uncertain.

B. The applicable rules must be confirmed; internal routing alone does not establish a paused deadline.

C. Every clarification pauses every legal deadline worldwide.

D. The clock begins only when the busiest team chooses to open the file.

2. What should staff avoid when clarifying scope?

A. Recording necessary clarification

B. Identifying an accountable request owner

C. Silently turning the combined request into deletion only

D. Preserving the original wording

Answers and explanations, page 149

Listen for the distinction

Correct the ten gaps. Explain the account uncertainty without demanding a passport by default or disclosing a guessed match.

A rights request may arrive in ordinary language

A person may not know legal terminology or the internal team name. Recognize the substance without requiring polished English or a particular phrase. Explain why a necessary clarification protects the person, and avoid turning internal routing into a needless obstacle.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Triage another combined data request

A message received on 7 March at 14:20 UTC asks for a copy of personal information and correction of an address. The sender cannot yet be securely matched to an account. Applicable timing rules have not been confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

14:20 UTC / identity clarification / address correction / to be confirmed

01 **Agent:** The receipt time is [1] _____.

02 **Coordinator:** The second requested action is [2] _____.

03 **Agent:** Before disclosure, the account match requires [3] _____.

04 **Coordinator:** The applicable deadline remains [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 14:20 UTC / **2.** address correction / **3.** identity clarification / **4.** to be confirmed

Why these answers fit, page 149

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record". Pia: "The system has a pause button for clarification. Should I use it now, or does the privacy team need to confirm the timing rule first?" Wen: [missing response] Pia: "The person may ask a family member to respond for them. How would that change the next step?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No. An erasure request has its own assessment. Applicable requirements and retention constraints may affect the outcome. We should not promise deletion before the responsible team has reviewed what the request covers.

B. Use data minimization. Request only what is necessary under the approved process to resolve the uncertainty. Formal identification is not automatically the right answer in every case, and unnecessary documents create their own handling risk.

C. Record the receipt timestamp and keep the original wording. It contains an access request and a deletion request, even though the person has not used our internal terminology or a legal label.

D. Do not assume that about the response deadline. Record the action and continue tracking dates unless the authorized assessment establishes the relevant timing treatment. An internal transfer is not permission to lose the original receipt date.

Answers and explanations, page 150

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / THIRD-PARTY RISK AND DUE DILIGENCE

Compare vendor data flows and dependencies, identify missing evidence, and communicate unresolved risk accurately.

Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure

Two vendors propose workforce reporting services. Vendor A proposes department-level counts; Vendor B requests names, work email addresses, and individual salary records. B also uses separate hosting and support subcontractors, but their locations and access are unconfirmed. Business lead Paolo prefers B because its demonstration looked easier to use. Risk coordinator Imani must clarify the actual service need, data necessity, subcontractor roles, controls, and contractual arrangements. Neither vendor is approved. A smaller stated dataset does not prove A is risk-free, and a completed questionnaire alone does not prove B is suitable.

People: Paolo, Business service owner; Imani, Third-party risk coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which proposed dataset is more detailed about individuals?

A. A's department-level counts as described
B. Both are established as identical
C. Neither contains any described information
D. B's names, work emails, and salary records

2. What is unknown about B's subcontractors?

A. The fact that the business saw a demonstration
B. The names of every employee using the service
C. Their locations and access
D. Whether B has mentioned any subcontractors

3. What is the current approval status?

A. Neither vendor is approved.
B. B is approved by the demonstration.
C. A is automatically approved because it proposes counts.
D. Both are approved once a questionnaire is submitted.

Answers and explanations, page 151

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

due diligence

Appropriate investigation before or during a relationship to understand relevant facts and risks.

conduct vendor due diligence

business rationale

The reason a service or relationship is needed.

document the business rationale

data flow

How information is collected, moved, accessed, stored, and used.

map the data flow

data necessity

Whether information is needed for the stated purpose.

assess data necessity

purpose limitation

Restricting use to the relevant permitted purposes under applicable requirements.

define purpose limitations

subcontractor

A party engaged by a supplier to perform part of the work.

identify subcontractors

subprocessor

A further processor engaged in a processing arrangement under relevant data-protection rules.

verify subprocessor roles

fourth party

A downstream provider on which a direct supplier relies.

assess fourth-party dependencies

cross-border transfer

Movement or access to information across relevant national boundaries.

assess cross-border transfers

onward disclosure

Further sharing beyond an initial recipient.

identify onward disclosures

B Vocabulary in use / continued

DPA

Data processing agreement or addendum governing specified personal-data processing arrangements.

review the DPA

contractual safeguard

A contract provision intended to address a specified risk or obligation.

assess contractual safeguards

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

due diligence DUE DILIGENCE

conduct vendor due diligence

Keep the meaning precise: Appropriate investigation before or during a relationship to understand relevant facts and risks.

subcontractor SUBCONTRACTOR

identify subcontractors

Keep the meaning precise: A party engaged by a supplier to perform part of the work.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

security questionnaire

A structured set of questions about a supplier's security practices.

evaluate questionnaire responses

audit right

A contractual or other right to examine specified records or practices.

clarify audit rights

retention period

The length of time information is kept under stated requirements.

verify retention periods

inherent risk

Risk considered before the specified controls or responses.

assess inherent risk

risk acceptance

An authorized decision to take a defined risk under the relevant framework.

document risk acceptance

ongoing monitoring

Continuing review of relevant changes and performance after initial assessment.

plan ongoing monitoring

assurance report

A report providing an assessment within a defined scope, period, and method.

review assurance-report scope

incident notification

Communication about specified incidents under the applicable rules or agreement.

define incident-notification duties

deletion verification

Evidence supporting that specified information was deleted as required.

request deletion verification

residual risk

Risk remaining after the assessed controls or responses.

describe residual risk

remediation

Work to correct an identified weakness or issue.

track remediation

exit plan

Arrangements for ending the relationship and handling dependencies and data.

assess the exit plan

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

contractual safeguard CONTRACTUAL SAFEGUARD

assess contractual safeguards

Keep the meaning precise: A contract provision intended to address a specified risk or obligation.

retention period RETENTION PERIOD

verify retention periods

Keep the meaning precise: The length of time information is kept under stated requirements.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the benefit

The demonstration suggests B may be easier for the team to use.

Clarify the purpose

Which decisions does the reporting service need to support?

Compare the inputs

A proposes department counts; B requests person-level salary and contact data.

Challenge necessity

Which of those individual fields are needed for the agreed purpose?

Map the flow

Where is each field stored, accessed, and sent?

Identify downstream roles

What do the hosting and support subcontractors actually do?

Keep locations open

Their access locations are not yet confirmed.

Avoid a label shortcut

Calling the data aggregate does not by itself establish anonymity.

Assess evidence

The questionnaire is a starting point, not a completed approval.

Check scope

Does the assurance evidence cover the proposed service and current period?

Clarify safeguards

We need the relevant processing, access, retention, and notification arrangements.

Check the end of the relationship

What happens to the data and dependencies when the service ends?

Separate risk states

Assess the initial exposure and the risk remaining after verified controls.

Name the decision authority

Any risk acceptance belongs to the designated authorized role.

Monitor change

Material changes to data use or subcontractors need the agreed review.

Close the recommendation

Record the business benefit, evidence, unresolved gaps, and approval status together.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Challenge necessity
Useful wording: Which of those individual fields are needed for the agreed purpose?

Purpose: Map the flow
Useful wording: Where is each field stored, accessed, and sent?

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which comparison is justified?

A. B is unsuitable solely because it has any subcontractor.

B. A and B are identical because their demonstrations have similar charts.

C. B proposes more person-level data and unresolved downstream access, requiring relevant assessment.

D. A has zero risk because it uses the word counts.

2. What is a useful question about salary fields?

A. Can they be collected simply because the vendor requested them?

B. Does a colorful dashboard eliminate the need to know?

C. Can the business hide the fields from the risk team?

D. Are they necessary for the agreed reporting purpose, and who would access them?

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Whether information is needed for the stated purpose. Which term fits?

A. risk acceptance

B. data necessity

C. cross-border transfer

D. audit right

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure". Paolo: "I just found two other companies in B's diagram: hosting and support. The arrows do not show whether support staff can read the salary records." Imani: [missing response] Paolo: "The sales team called them standard subcontractors. Does that description settle the question?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Let us preserve that usability benefit while checking the business rationale. Which decisions do the reports need to support, and what information is actually necessary to make them?

B. Leave the location unconfirmed and flag possible cross-border transfers for the appropriate review. An assumed location can distort both the risk assessment and the contractual questions that follow.

C. We need the data flow and access roles. A diagram should show where the information is stored, who can reach it, and what each downstream provider does with it.

D. That makes data necessity an important question. We should ask why each person-level field is needed instead of assuming a more detailed input always produces a more suitable service.

Answers and explanations, page 151

One useful distinction

Department-level counts may reduce some exposure relative to identified salary records, but the actual fields, group sizes, combinations, access, and use still matter. Do not label a dataset anonymous or a vendor risk-free merely because the proposal uses the word aggregate.

E Conversation

Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure

Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

data flow / ongoing monitoring / subcontractor / security questionnaire / risk acceptance / contractual safeguards / cross-border transfers / data necessity / inherent risk / business rationale

01 **Paolo:** B's demonstration was easier to use. Both vendors produce workforce reports, so I hoped the risk review could be the same for each.

02 **Imani:** Let us preserve that usability benefit while checking the [1] _____. Which decisions do the reports need to support, and what information is actually necessary to make them?

03 **Paolo:** We need department-level planning. A proposes counts by department, while B asks for employee names, work emails, and individual salaries.

04 **Imani:** That makes [2] _____ an important question. We should ask why each person-level field is needed instead of assuming a more detailed input always produces a more suitable service.

05 **Paolo:** I just found two other companies in B's diagram: hosting and support. The arrows do not show whether support staff can read the salary records.

06 **Imani:** We need the [3] _____ and access roles. A diagram should show where the information is stored, who can reach it, and what each downstream provider does with it.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Paolo:** The sales team called them standard subcontractors. Does that description settle the question?

08 **Imani:** No. We need to identify each [4] _____ and its actual role. Whether a particular party is a subprocessor under the relevant arrangement needs assessment, not an assumption from a sales label.

09 **Paolo:** We have not been told where the hosting and support activities occur. Should I put our own country in the form for now?

10 **Imani:** Leave the location unconfirmed and flag possible [5] _____ for the appropriate review. An assumed location can distort both the risk assessment and the contractual questions that follow.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Paolo:** A's proposal is simpler. Can we mark it low risk without asking anything further because it only mentions department counts?

12 **Imani:** Not automatically. Its [6] _____ depends on the actual fields, group sizes, combinations, access, and use. Counts can reduce some exposure, but the label aggregate does not establish anonymity or remove every service risk.

13 **Paolo:** B returned the questionnaire this morning. Purchasing is asking whether completed means cleared. What should I tell them is still outstanding?

14 **Imani:** The [7] _____ is one source of information. We still need relevant evidence, its scope and date, any exceptions, and the actual arrangements for this service.

15 **Paolo:** What should the agreement and operational plan cover beyond the questionnaire answers?

16 **Imani:** The appropriate [8] _____ and operating arrangements need review: permitted use, access, downstream providers, retention, incident communication, and what happens at exit. A document title alone does not settle those questions.

17 **Paolo:** If some uncertainty remains after those checks, can the business record it and decide whether to proceed?

18 **Imani:** Any [9] _____ must follow the actual authority framework. The decision-maker needs the remaining exposure and evidence gaps, not a summary that hides them behind a favorable demonstration.

Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure / continued

19 **Paolo:** I will request the data-flow details and field rationale, and keep both vendors unapproved until the relevant decision is made.

20 **Imani:** Good. Include [10] _____ in the proposal as well. Data use and subcontractors can change after onboarding, so the relationship needs a defined review process rather than a one-time green label.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. business rationale / **2.** data necessity / **3.** data flow / **4.** subcontractor / **5.** cross-border transfers / **6.** inherent risk / **7.** security questionnaire / **8.** contractual safeguards / **9.** risk acceptance / **10.** ongoing monitoring

Why these answers fit, page 152

F Check accuracy and scope

Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure

Return to the case

Two vendors propose workforce reporting services. Vendor A proposes department-level counts; Vendor B requests names, work email addresses, and individual salary records. B also uses separate hosting and support subcontractors, but their locations and access are unconfirmed. Business lead Paolo prefers B because its demonstration looked easier to use. Risk coordinator Imani must clarify the actual service need, data necessity, subcontractor roles, controls, and contractual arrangements. Neither vendor is approved. A smaller stated dataset does not prove A is risk-free, and a completed questionnaire alone does not prove B is suitable.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. How should a questionnaire be treated?

A. As permission to ignore subcontractor access
B. As proof every answer has been independently tested
C. As one source to evaluate alongside relevant supporting evidence and gaps
D. As a universal certificate of legal compliance

2. Who may accept an identified residual risk?

A. The vendor's salesperson on the customer's behalf
B. The intake system automatically after an upload
C. The designated authorized decision-maker under the actual framework
D. Anyone who liked the demonstration

Answers and explanations, page 154

Listen for the distinction

Correct the ten gaps. Ask about each downstream provider, its access, and location while leaving unknown details unconfirmed.

Risk questions should connect to the service need

A business team may hear due diligence as opposition to its preferred supplier. Explain which exposure each question addresses and what evidence would help. Keep the usability benefit visible while distinguishing commercial preference from an authorized risk decision.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Compare another pair of proposed services

Vendor C proposes site-level totals. Vendor D requests named staff records and uses an external support provider whose access is unknown. Neither is approved, and the business purpose needs clarification.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

access / approved / zero risk / business purpose

01 **Coordinator:** The unresolved support issue is [1] _____.

02 **Owner:** We must clarify the service's [2] _____.

03 **Coordinator:** Neither supplier is currently [3] _____.

04 **Owner:** A site-level-total label does not prove [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. access / **2.** business purpose / **3.** approved / **4.** zero risk

Why these answers fit, page 154

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure". Paolo: "B returned the questionnaire this morning. Purchasing is asking whether completed means cleared. What should I tell them is still outstanding?" Imani: [missing response] Paolo: "What should the agreement and operational plan cover beyond the questionnaire answers?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Let us preserve that usability benefit while checking the business rationale. Which decisions do the reports need to support, and what information is actually necessary to make them?

B. Any risk acceptance must follow the actual authority framework. The decision-maker needs the remaining exposure and evidence gaps, not a summary that hides them behind a favorable demonstration.

C. The security questionnaire is one source of information. We still need relevant evidence, its scope and date, any exceptions, and the actual arrangements for this service.

D. Leave the location unconfirmed and flag possible cross-border transfers for the appropriate review. An assumed location can distort both the risk assessment and the contractual questions that follow.

Answers and explanations, page 155

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Privacy Operations and Data Requests" and "Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Subject access request; a request to exercise the relevant right of access. Which term fits?

A. SAR

B. receipt timestamp

C. third-party information

D. identity verification

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A downstream provider on which a direct supplier relies. Which term fits?

A. inherent risk

B. security questionnaire

C. due diligence

D. fourth party

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding". Elena: "I remember the date clearly, although I would need to check my notes for the time. I do not want to guess." Noah: [missing response] Elena: "I have my own notes and a message about the invoice. I have not changed them or accessed anyone else's account." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I can explain our confidentiality process, but I cannot promise absolute secrecy. Information needs controlled handling by the appropriate people, and some details may need to be shared for a fair review.

B. Keep that distinction in the chronology. We can record the date you recall and mark the time as unconfirmed. The reviewer can assess relevant records and context rather than rely on invented precision.

C. No. Possible corroboration should be assessed through the authorized review. You can identify a potential witness, but do not coach an account or ask someone to confirm details they did not observe.

D. Thank you for raising it. I will separate your reported observation from your interpretation. You saw the approved status and blank field. Did you personally see any payment to the manager?

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure". Paolo: "If some uncertainty remains after those checks, can the business record it and decide whether to proceed?" Imani: [missing response] Paolo: "I will request the data-flow details and field rationale, and keep both vendors unapproved until the relevant decision is made." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Let us preserve that usability benefit while checking the business rationale. Which decisions do the reports need to support, and what information is actually necessary to make them?

B. That makes data necessity an important question. We should ask why each person-level field is needed instead of assuming a more detailed input always produces a more suitable service.

C. Leave the location unconfirmed and flag possible cross-border transfers for the appropriate review. An assumed location can distort both the risk assessment and the contractual questions that follow.

D. Any risk acceptance must follow the actual authority framework. The decision-maker needs the remaining exposure and evidence gaps, not a summary that hides them behind a favorable demonstration.

Answers and explanations, page 172

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / TRAINING, ATTESTATIONS, AND CULTURE

Report completion separately from understanding and explain a policy through precise, role-relevant examples.

> **Completion is not the same as understanding**
>
> The learning system shows 490 completions among 500 assigned employees, or 98%. Separately, 20 volunteers answer an application question; only eight answer correctly. Fictional policy W4 requires disclosure of outside paid work before it begins, including weekend work. Disclosure is not automatic prohibition, and the review outcome depends on the actual policy process. Employees still ask whether weekend assignments count. Training coordinator Sofia and compliance adviser Ren must report the two measures accurately and improve the explanation. The volunteer group is not established as representative of all 500 employees.

People: Sofia, Compliance training coordinator; Ren, Compliance adviser.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What does the 98% figure measure?

A. Proof that nobody needs further explanation
B. Recorded course completion among 500 assigned employees
C. Verified compliant behavior by 98% of all employees
D. Correct answers by 98% of the volunteer group

2. How many volunteers answered correctly?

A. Four hundred ninety of five hundred
B. Twenty of twenty
C. Eight of twenty
D. Twelve of twenty

3. What does W4 require for paid weekend work?

A. Disclosure before it begins
B. Automatic prohibition in every case
C. Disclosure only after payment arrives
D. No disclosure because it occurs on a weekend

Answers and explanations, page 156

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

LMS
Learning management system; a platform for assigning, delivering, and recording training.

review LMS records

assigned cohort
The defined group required to complete a learning activity.

verify the assigned cohort

attestation
A recorded statement confirming specified facts or understanding, with its meaning defined.

obtain an attestation

knowledge check
An assessment of particular knowledge at a stated point.

administer a knowledge check

scenario-based assessment
An assessment using realistic situations to test defined decisions.

use scenario-based assessment

role-based training
Instruction tailored to the tasks and risks of particular roles.

deliver role-based training

completion rate
The share of an assigned population meeting a defined completion condition.

calculate the completion rate

completion criterion
The condition used to mark an activity complete.

define completion criteria

acknowledgment
Confirmation of receipt or awareness under the stated process.

record policy acknowledgment

application question
A question testing use of a rule in a concrete situation.

design an application question

learning objective
A specific capability the instruction aims to develop.

define learning objectives

job aid
A concise reference supporting a task at the point of work.

provide a job aid

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

LMS LMS

review LMS records

Keep the meaning precise: Learning management system; a platform for assigning, delivering, and recording training.

acknowledgment ACKNOWLEDGMENT

record policy acknowledgment

Keep the meaning precise: Confirmation of receipt or awareness under the stated process.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

plain language

Wording that the intended audience can understand and use.

explain in plain language

accessibility

The ability of people with varied needs to access and use the material.

check training accessibility

speak-up culture

A work environment that supports raising questions and concerns.

support a speak-up culture

application gap

Difficulty applying a known rule to a real situation.

address application gaps

representativeness

How well a group reflects the population relevant to a conclusion.

assess representativeness

follow-up assessment

A later check of a specified learning outcome.

conduct a follow-up assessment

localization

Adaptation of material for a particular language, setting, or audience.

review localization

advice channel

A defined route for obtaining guidance on a question.

identify the advice channel

knowledge gap

Missing or inaccurate understanding of specified information.

identify knowledge gaps

volunteer sample

A group whose members choose to participate.

qualify a volunteer sample

remedial learning

Targeted instruction addressing an identified learning need.

provide remedial learning

behavior measure

An indicator of what people actually do, distinct from attendance or reported knowledge.

define behavior measures

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

job aid JOB AID

provide a job aid

Keep the meaning precise: A concise reference supporting a task at the point of work.

speak-up culture SPEAK-UP CULTURE

support a speak-up culture

Keep the meaning precise: A work environment that supports raising questions and concerns.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Name the measure

Ninety-eight percent refers to recorded training completion.

Keep the remainder visible

Ten assigned employees lack recorded completion.

Qualify the sample

We have not established that the volunteers represent the whole workforce.

State the rule plainly

Under W4, disclose outside paid work before it begins.

Separate disclosure and outcome

Disclosure does not automatically mean the work is prohibited.

Welcome the question

Asking how the rule applies is a useful part of learning.

Make help available

Give employees a clear advice channel for uncertain cases.

Test the specific objective

Use a follow-up scenario to check whether the timing rule is understood.

State the denominator

Four hundred ninety of five hundred assigned employees completed it.

Report the separate check

Eight of twenty volunteers answered the application question correctly.

Avoid the overclaim

We cannot report ninety-eight percent compliant behavior from this measure.

Address the example

Weekend work is included in that disclosure requirement.

Explain the next route

The designated reviewer applies the actual policy process.

Focus the instruction

Let us practice the distinction between disclosure timing and approval outcome.

Check accessibility

Confirm that the wording and format are usable for the intended audience.

Close accurately

Report completion, the limited application result, and the targeted follow-up separately.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Report the separate check
Useful wording: Eight of twenty volunteers answered the application question correctly.

Purpose: Qualify the sample
Useful wording: We have not established that the volunteers represent the whole workforce.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which headline is supported?

A. Every non-completer has deliberately refused training.

B. Training completion is 98%; a separate volunteer check identified an application gap.

C. Ninety-eight percent of employees behave compliantly in every situation.

D. Forty percent of all employees understand every policy.

2. An employee plans paid weekend work. What does W4 require?

A. Automatic resignation from the outside role

B. Disclosure before the work begins

C. Waiting until the first payment arrives

D. No action because weekends are outside normal hours

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The condition used to mark an activity complete. Which term fits?

A. completion criterion

B. accessibility

C. representativeness

D. scenario-based assessment

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Completion is not the same as understanding". Sofia: "The application check tells a different story: eight correct answers from twenty volunteers. I cannot use the five-hundred-person denominator for that result." Ren: [missing response] Sofia: "Most questions were about paid weekend assignments. People thought the disclosure rule only concerned work during their normal hours." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That is forty percent in the volunteer sample. It identifies a concern worth addressing, but it does not establish that forty percent of the whole workforce understands the policy or that everyone else has failed.

B. Then the application gap is specific. W4 requires disclosure of outside paid work before it begins, including weekends. We can explain that plainly without adding a rule that all outside work is prohibited.

C. That overstates the completion rate. Four hundred ninety of five hundred assigned employees completed the course. It does not measure every person's understanding or behavior in the situations covered by the policy.

D. An acknowledgment means what its wording and process establish. It is not automatic evidence of correct application in every situation, especially when the follow-up questions show a particular misunderstanding.

Answers and explanations, page 156

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Completion is 490 divided by 500, or 98%, leaving 10 without recorded completion. The volunteer application result is eight divided by 20, or 40%. Different populations and measures prevent either percentage from replacing the other.

E Conversation

Completion is not the same as understanding

Completion is not the same as understanding

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

job aid / role-based training / application gap / acknowledgment / follow-up assessment / volunteer sample / accessibility / advice channel / completion rate / assigned cohort

01 **Sofia:** The learning dashboard shows ninety-eight percent completion. Our summary currently says the workforce is ninety-eight percent compliant.

02 **Ren:** That overstates the [1] _____. Four hundred ninety of five hundred assigned employees completed the course. It does not measure every person's understanding or behavior in the situations covered by the policy.

03 **Sofia:** Ten people do not have a completion record. I will check the assignments and any approved exceptions rather than assume they refused.

04 **Ren:** Good. Keep the [2] _____ and completion criteria clear. We should know who was assigned and what the system counts as complete before drawing conclusions from the percentage.

05 **Sofia:** The application check tells a different story: eight correct answers from twenty volunteers. I cannot use the five-hundred-person denominator for that result.

06 **Ren:** That is forty percent in the [3] _____. It identifies a concern worth addressing, but it does not establish that forty percent of the whole workforce understands the policy or that everyone else has failed.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Sofia:** Most questions were about paid weekend assignments. People thought the disclosure rule only concerned work during their normal hours.

08 **Ren:** Then the [4] _____ is specific. W4 requires disclosure of outside paid work before it begins, including weekends. We can explain that plainly without adding a rule that all outside work is prohibited.

09 **Sofia:** The course includes an acknowledgment at the end. Could we use that as evidence that everyone accepted the exact meaning of every example?

10 **Ren:** An [5] _____ means what its wording and process establish. It is not automatic evidence of correct application in every situation, especially when the follow-up questions show a particular misunderstanding.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Completion is not the same as understanding

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Sofia:** Someone showed me the policy on their phone. They could not find the weekend example. Could we put the trigger and advice contact in a short reminder?

12 **Ren:** A [6] _____ can state the trigger, timing, and advice route. It should point to the current policy and avoid simplifying disclosure required into activity forbidden.

13 **Sofia:** Some roles rarely face this issue, while others receive outside-work offers regularly. We should not assume one long module fits them equally.

14 **Ren:** Use [7] _____ with relevant examples. Keep the rule consistent, but make the situations recognizable to the employees who need to apply it.

15 **Sofia:** A few employees hesitate to ask because they think a question will be treated as evidence that they did something wrong.

16 **Ren:** We need a credible [8] _____. Asking before acting can help the policy work. We should not train people to hide uncertainty merely to preserve a clean-looking dashboard.

17 **Sofia:** I will review the wording and format as well. Some of the examples rely on expressions that are hard for multilingual teams to interpret.

18 **Ren:** Check [9] _____ and localization with the intended audience. Completion in the system does not prove that the language or format made the requirement easy to understand.

19 **Sofia:** After the revised example, we can ask another fixed scenario about when disclosure is needed and what disclosure does not automatically mean.

20 **Ren:** That [10] _____ matches the objective. Report completion, the limited application result, and the targeted next check separately, then assess whether the actual misunderstanding has been reduced.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. completion rate / **2.** assigned cohort / **3.** volunteer sample / **4.** application gap / **5.** acknowledgment / **6.** job aid / **7.** role-based training / **8.** advice channel / **9.** accessibility / **10.** follow-up assessment

Why these answers fit, page 158

F Check accuracy and scope

Completion is not the same as understanding

Return to the case

The learning system shows 490 completions among 500 assigned employees, or 98%. Separately, 20 volunteers answer an application question; only eight answer correctly. Fictional policy W4 requires disclosure of outside paid work before it begins, including weekend work. Disclosure is not automatic prohibition, and the review outcome depends on the actual policy process. Employees still ask whether weekend assignments count. Training coordinator Sofia and compliance adviser Ren must report the two measures accurately and improve the explanation. The volunteer group is not established as representative of all 500 employees.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What should be said about the 40% application result?

A. It is the verified understanding rate of all five hundred employees.

B. It replaces the completion denominator.

C. It proves the training caused misconduct.

D. It describes eight correct answers among twenty volunteers, with representativeness unestablished.

2. Which follow-up is most relevant?

A. A demand that employees stop asking questions

B. Reclassification of every volunteer as non-compliant

C. A clear W4 example, an advice route, and a later check of the same disclosure-timing distinction

D. Another completion reminder with no explanation of the misunderstood rule

Answers and explanations, page 159

Listen for the distinction

Correct the ten gaps. State that paid weekend work requires disclosure before starting, not automatic rejection.

Questions can indicate engagement, not defiance

People may stay silent if asking for clarification is treated as failure. Welcome questions about a concrete rule and provide accessible explanations. Keep completion reporting honest while testing whether employees can apply the policy in the situations their roles actually encounter.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Report another training result precisely

A course has 285 completions among 300 assigned employees. A separate group of 30 volunteers answers one application question; 18 answer correctly. The group is not established as representative.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

representativeness / 60% / 95% / fifteen

01 **Coordinator:** The completion rate is [1] _____.

02 **Adviser:** The number without recorded completion is [2] _____.

03 **Coordinator:** The volunteer correct-answer rate is [3] _____.

04 **Adviser:** Generalizing that result requires assessing [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 95% / **2.** fifteen / **3.** 60% / **4.** representativeness

Why these answers fit, page 159

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Completion is not the same as understanding". Sofia: "Some roles rarely face this issue, while others receive outside-work offers regularly. We should not assume one long module fits them equally." Ren: [missing response] Sofia: "A few employees hesitate to ask because they think a question will be treated as evidence that they did something wrong." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Use role-based training with relevant examples. Keep the rule consistent, but make the situations recognizable to the employees who need to apply it.

B. Check accessibility and localization with the intended audience. Completion in the system does not prove that the language or format made the requirement easy to understand.

C. A job aid can state the trigger, timing, and advice route. It should point to the current policy and avoid simplifying disclosure required into activity forbidden.

D. That follow-up assessment matches the objective. Report completion, the limited application result, and the targeted next check separately, then assess whether the actual misunderstanding has been reduced.

Answers and explanations, page 160

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / GOVERNANCE, REPORTING, AND RISK COMMITTEES

Report action status, remaining exposure, and requested decisions against explicit closure criteria.

> **An approved plan is not a closed action**
>
> On 1 October, committee action G12 appears as complete because its remediation plan was approved on 12 September. Its due date was 30 September. The fictional closure rule requires implementation evidence and independent verification; neither is available. Action owner Owen has requested 15 October as a new due date, but no extension is approved. Risk coordinator Sara must correct the status for the 7 October committee meeting, preserve the history, and identify the decision needed. Approval of a revised date would not itself prove implementation or accept all remaining risk.

People: Owen, Remediation action owner; Sara, Risk committee coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Why was G12 marked complete?

A. The due date was removed from the record.
B. The plan was approved on 12 September.
C. Implementation and independent verification were both completed.
D. The committee approved an extension to 15 October.

2. What evidence is needed for closure under the stated rule?

A. Only the action owner's preferred status label
B. Implementation evidence and independent verification
C. Only a newly proposed date
D. Only the approved plan

3. What is the status of 15 October?

A. The original deadline
B. An already approved extension
C. The date independent verification was completed
D. Requested but not approved

Answers and explanations, page 161

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

governance
The structures and processes for direction, oversight, and accountability.

support effective governance

committee charter
A document defining a committee's purpose, scope, and authority.

review the committee charter

terms of reference
The agreed purpose, responsibilities, and operating boundaries of a body or task.

confirm terms of reference

quorum
The participation requirement for a body to conduct specified business under its rules.

verify quorum

decision rights
The allocation of authority to make particular decisions.

clarify decision rights

delegated authority
Decision power assigned within specified limits.

verify delegated authority

action owner
The person responsible for delivering a defined action.

identify the action owner

risk owner
The person accountable for managing a specified risk under the framework.

identify the risk owner

closure criterion
A condition required to mark an action closed.

apply closure criteria

implementation evidence
Records showing that the planned change has actually been put into effect.

verify implementation evidence

independent verification
Assessment by an appropriately separate reviewer under the relevant requirements.

obtain independent verification

residual exposure
The risk remaining after the relevant measures are assessed.

describe residual exposure

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

governance GOVERNANCE

support effective governance

Keep the meaning precise: The structures and processes for direction, oversight, and accountability.

delegated authority DELEGATED AUTHORITY

verify delegated authority

Keep the meaning precise: Decision power assigned within specified limits.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

proposed extension

A requested change to timing that has not yet been approved.

record a proposed extension

approved extension

A timing change authorized through the relevant process.

document an approved extension

overdue action

An action whose applicable due date has passed without completion.

report overdue actions

status date

The date as of which a status report is accurate.

state the status date

risk appetite

The broad amount or type of risk an organization is willing to take under its framework.

define risk appetite

risk tolerance

Specified acceptable boundaries around relevant risk or performance measures.

monitor risk tolerance

KRI

Key risk indicator; a defined measure used to monitor risk conditions.

interpret a KRI

risk register

A record of identified risks, ownership, assessment, and responses.

maintain the risk register

mitigation plan

Proposed actions intended to reduce a specified risk.

approve a mitigation plan

decision log

A record of decisions, authority, reasons, and relevant conditions.

maintain the decision log

exception reporting

Reporting departures from stated criteria or expectations.

provide exception reporting

escalation threshold

A defined condition requiring referral to a higher or different authority.

apply escalation thresholds

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

residual exposure RESIDUAL EXPOSURE

describe residual exposure

Keep the meaning precise: The risk remaining after the relevant measures are assessed.

risk appetite RISK APPETITE

define risk appetite

Keep the meaning precise: The broad amount or type of risk an organization is willing to take under its framework.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the reporting date

This status is as of the first of October.

Keep closure separate

Plan approval does not satisfy the closure criteria.

Correct the label

The action remains open and overdue against the thirtieth of September deadline.

Preserve history

Keep the original deadline and the reason for each status change.

Separate authority

A date change does not automatically accept the remaining risk.

Identify ownership

Owen owns delivery of the action; the risk owner addresses the remaining exposure.

Define verification

The independent reviewer must assess the required implementation evidence.

Escalate appropriately

Use the actual escalation threshold and committee mandate.

Credit the completed milestone

The remediation plan was approved on the twelfth of September.

Name the missing evidence

Implementation evidence and independent verification are outstanding.

Qualify the new date

The fifteenth of October is requested, not approved.

Ask for the actual decision

The committee needs to consider the extension request through its authority process.

Avoid an unsupported score

We have no defined basis for calling the action ninety percent complete.

State the impact

Explain what remains exposed while the action is unverified.

Record conditions

Any decision should identify its scope, owner, conditions, and date.

Close the report

Show the achieved milestone, missing evidence, current deadline, and requested decision together.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Name the missing evidence
Useful wording: Implementation evidence and independent verification are outstanding.

Purpose: Correct the label
Useful wording: The action remains open and overdue against the thirtieth of September deadline.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which 1 October status is accurate?

A. Open and overdue; plan approved, implementation and verification evidence outstanding.
B. Complete because the plan was approved.
C. On time because 15 October has been requested.
D. Independently verified because the owner attended the meeting.

2. What would an approved extension establish by itself?

A. Completed implementation
B. Automatic acceptance of every legal or operational risk
C. Independent verification of the control
D. An authorized timing change under its stated conditions

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The participation requirement for a body to conduct specified business under its rules. Which term fits?

A. quorum
B. mitigation plan
C. closure criterion
D. overdue action

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An approved plan is not a closed action". Owen: "The plan took weeks to agree. If the paper just says overdue, that work disappears. Can we show the milestone without calling the action closed?" Sara: [missing response] Owen: "Can I describe it as ninety percent complete? That might communicate that the plan is nearly ready to deliver." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. The action owner and risk owner can have different responsibilities. Naming one person on the tracker does not automatically transfer every decision or accountability to them.

B. We must check the decision rights. A timing extension and risk acceptance are different decisions. The committee's mandate and any delegated authority determine what it can actually decide.

C. The status date lets us be precise. We will show the achieved milestone and the outstanding evidence together. Accurate overdue reporting does not erase the work already completed.

D. The closure criteria require implementation evidence and independent verification. Neither is available yet. We can record the approved plan as a completed milestone without treating the whole action as closed.

Answers and explanations, page 161

> **One useful distinction**
>
> As of 1 October, the 30 September due date has passed and no approved extension exists. G12 therefore remains open and overdue under the supplied facts. The 15 October request must remain labeled proposed until the authorized process decides it.

E Conversation

An approved plan is not a closed action

An approved plan is not a closed action

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

exception reporting / decision rights / independent verification / decision log / closure criteria / status date / proposed extension / action owner / residual exposure / Implementation evidence

01 **Owen:** G12 is marked complete in the tracker. The plan was approved on the twelfth of September, so I assumed we could close the action.

02 **Sara:** The [1] _____ require implementation evidence and independent verification. Neither is available yet. We can record the approved plan as a completed milestone without treating the whole action as closed.

03 **Owen:** The original date was the thirtieth of September. I requested the fifteenth of October because the implementation work is taking longer.

04 **Sara:** That is a [2] _____, not an approved one. As of the first of October, the applicable deadline is still the thirtieth of September, so the action is open and overdue.

05 **Owen:** The plan took weeks to agree. If the paper just says overdue, that work disappears. Can we show the milestone without calling the action closed?

06 **Sara:** The [3] _____ lets us be precise. We will show the achieved milestone and the outstanding evidence together. Accurate overdue reporting does not erase the work already completed.

E Conversation / continued

07 **Owen:** Can I describe it as ninety percent complete? That might communicate that the plan is nearly ready to deliver.

08 **Sara:** Not without a defined basis. [4] _____ needs to show the actual change required by the action. A persuasive percentage is not a substitute for the records the closure rule specifies.

09 **Owen:** I can provide the deployment records when they are ready. Who then decides whether they meet the requirement?

10 **Sara:** The designated reviewer performs [5] _____. We need that assessment recorded, including any exceptions, rather than assume your submission automatically proves the action can be closed.

Conversation continues on the next page.

An approved plan is not a closed action

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Owen:** For the seventh of October meeting, I want the committee to approve the revised date. What else should the paper make clear?

12 **Sara:** It should explain the remaining [6] _____ and the effect of delay. The risk owner needs that information, alongside your delivery plan, rather than only a request to make the overdue label disappear.

13 **Owen:** If the committee agrees to the new date, would that count as accepting the remaining risk until then?

14 **Sara:** We must check the [7] _____. A timing extension and risk acceptance are different decisions. The committee's mandate and any delegated authority determine what it can actually decide.

15 **Owen:** I will keep myself listed as the delivery owner, but the business risk owner should speak to the consequences and any interim measures.

16 **Sara:** Correct. The [8] _____ and risk owner can have different responsibilities. Naming one person on the tracker does not automatically transfer every decision or accountability to them.

17 **Owen:** The tracker shows only one due-date field. If the extension is approved, where do we keep the original deadline and the committee's conditions?

18 **Sara:** Update the current field while preserving the [9] _____. Retain the original deadline, the request, and any authorized decision with its reasons and conditions. Do not rewrite the history to imply the action was never overdue.

An approved plan is not a closed action / continued

19 **Owen:** Then the paper will show plan approved, evidence outstanding, overdue as of the first, and the requested fifteenth-of-October extension.

20 **Sara:** Yes. That is useful [10] _____. The committee can assess the actual request and remaining exposure, and we can close G12 only when the required evidence and verification support closure.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. closure criteria / **2.** proposed extension / **3.** status date / **4.** Implementation evidence / **5.** independent verification / **6.** residual exposure / **7.** decision rights / **8.** action owner / **9.** decision log / **10.** exception reporting

Why these answers fit, page 163

F Check accuracy and scope

An approved plan is not a closed action

Return to the case

On 1 October, committee action G12 appears as complete because its remediation plan was approved on 12 September. Its due date was 30 September. The fictional closure rule requires implementation evidence and independent verification; neither is available. Action owner Owen has requested 15 October as a new due date, but no extension is approved. Risk coordinator Sara must correct the status for the 7 October committee meeting, preserve the history, and identify the decision needed. Approval of a revised date would not itself prove implementation or accept all remaining risk.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which record should be retained if timing changes?

A. An earlier approval date invented to remove lateness
B. A complete label without supporting evidence
C. The original deadline, extension decision, authority, reason, and new conditions
D. Only the newest date with all prior entries deleted

2. What should the committee paper request?

A. Closure solely to improve the overdue count
B. The specific extension decision and any separate action needed for remaining exposure
C. Approval of an undefined statement that everything is fine
D. Retroactive proof that evidence was already supplied

Answers and explanations, page 164

Listen for the distinction

Correct the ten gaps. Separate plan approval, implementation evidence, independent verification, and the proposed extension.

Accurate bad news is usable management information

An overdue action can be uncomfortable to report, especially after a visible milestone has been achieved. Credit the approved plan while keeping the unfinished evidence visible. A clear status enables a real decision; a reassuring label can hide the very issue the committee needs to address.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Report another action against its closure rule

Action K09 was due on 10 June. As of 12 June, its plan is approved but required implementation evidence and independent verification are missing. A 25 June extension has been requested but not approved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

proposed extension / open and overdue / 12 June / independent verification

01 **Coordinator:** The status date is [1] _____.

02 **Owner:** The current action status is [2] _____.

03 **Coordinator:** The twenty-fifth of June is a [3] _____.

04 **Owner:** Closure also requires [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 12 June / **2.** open and overdue / **3.** proposed extension / **4.** independent verification

Why these answers fit, page 164

F Say it / transfer to a new case / continued

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "An approved plan is not a closed action". Owen: "If the committee agrees to the new date, would that count as accepting the remaining risk until then?" Sara: [missing response] Owen: "I will keep myself listed as the delivery owner, but the business risk owner should speak to the consequences and any interim measures." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. The action owner and risk owner can have different responsibilities. Naming one person on the tracker does not automatically transfer every decision or accountability to them.

B. The status date lets us be precise. We will show the achieved milestone and the outstanding evidence together. Accurate overdue reporting does not erase the work already completed.

C. The closure criteria require implementation evidence and independent verification. Neither is available yet. We can record the approved plan as a completed milestone without treating the whole action as closed.

D. We must check the decision rights. A timing extension and risk acceptance are different decisions. The committee's mandate and any delegated authority determine what it can actually decide.

Answers and explanations, page 165

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Training, Attestations, and Culture" and "Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The defined group required to complete a learning activity. Which term fits?

A. application question
B. volunteer sample
C. localization
D. assigned cohort

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The person accountable for managing a specified risk under the framework. Which term fits?

A. KRI
B. governance
C. proposed extension
D. risk owner

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure". Paolo: "We have not been told where the hosting and support activities occur. Should I put our own country in the form for now?" Imani: [missing response] Paolo: "A's proposal is simpler. Can we mark it low risk without asking anything further because it only mentions department counts?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Leave the location unconfirmed and flag possible cross-border transfers for the appropriate review. An assumed location can distort both the risk assessment and the contractual questions that follow.
B. That makes data necessity an important question. We should ask why each person-level field is needed instead of assuming a more detailed input always produces a more suitable service.
C. Any risk acceptance must follow the actual authority framework. The decision-maker needs the remaining exposure and evidence gaps, not a summary that hides them behind a favorable demonstration.
D. Let us preserve that usability benefit while checking the business rationale. Which decisions do the reports need to support, and what information is actually necessary to make them?

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An approved plan is not a closed action". Owen: "The tracker shows only one due-date field. If the extension is approved, where do we keep the original deadline and the committee's conditions?" Sara: [missing response] Owen: "Then the paper will show plan approved, evidence outstanding, overdue as of the first, and the requested fifteenth-of-October extension." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Not without a defined basis. Implementation evidence needs to show the actual change required by the action. A persuasive percentage is not a substitute for the records the closure rule specifies.

B. That is a proposed extension, not an approved one. As of the first of October, the applicable deadline is still the thirtieth of September, so the action is open and overdue.

C. It should explain the remaining residual exposure and the effect of delay. The risk owner needs that information, alongside your delivery plan, rather than only a request to make the overdue label disappear.

D. Update the current field while preserving the decision log. Retain the original deadline, the request, and any authorized decision with its reasons and conditions. Do not rewrite the history to imply the action was never overdue.

Answers and explanations, page 175

Language for the next case

Review the bill line by line

engagement terms

The agreed engagement terms set the associate rate at 300 dollars and partner rate at 500; the invoice cannot replace those terms with an unapproved rate.

Theo: Certainly. Let us use the engagement terms as the starting point. The associate rate is three hundred per hour, although this invoice used three hundred twenty-five.

duplicate entry

Counsel has confirmed that one of the four partner hours is duplicated, supporting a separate 500-dollar removal rather than an assumption based only on similar text.

Theo: Counsel has checked the underlying entries and confirmed a duplicate entry. Removing that one hour leaves three hours at five hundred, or fifteen hundred.

block billing

Block billing combines multiple tasks in one time entry; this fictional client's guidelines require a factual task breakdown, not invented allocations to make the entry pass review.

Theo: I will query that block billing. We should obtain the recorded detail, not invent equal fractions for each task because the total happens to reconcile.

rate adjustment

Twelve hours multiplied by the 25-dollar rate difference produces a 300-dollar reduction; the hours themselves are unchanged.

Theo: That creates a rate adjustment of three hundred dollars. I will correct the rate, not reduce the recorded hours to force the same total.

revised invoice

The revised invoice is 3,600 associate fees plus 1,500 partner fees plus 150 expense, totaling 5,250, with no tax or discount in the exercise.

Theo: Correct. The revised invoice should total five thousand two hundred fifty. That is eight hundred less than the original six thousand fifty, without changing the allowed expense.

matter owner

The matter owner holds payment-approval responsibility in the supplied workflow; legal operations checking arithmetic does not itself authorize payment.

Theo: And the matter owner still needs to approve payment. Your review documents the discrepancies and reconciliation, rather than replacing that approval.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Review the bill line by line

Fictional engagement: associate $300/hour, partner $500/hour. Invoice: associate 12 hours at $325; partner four hours at $500, including a disputed one-hour duplicate; $150 allowed expense. No tax or discount. Counsel confirms the duplicate should be removed. Legal operations checks the correction; the matter owner approves payment.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

engagement terms / revised invoice / duplicate entry / block billing / matter owner / rate adjustment

01 **Amal:** I have two queries on the matter's invoice: the associate rate and a partner entry that appears twice. Can we reconcile them before the matter owner approves payment?

02 **Theo:** Certainly. Let us use the [1] _____ as the starting point. The associate rate is three hundred per hour, although this invoice used three hundred twenty-five.

03 **Amal:** Twelve hours at the billed rate gives three thousand nine hundred. At the agreed rate, the same twelve hours comes to three thousand six hundred.

04 **Theo:** That creates a [2] _____ of three hundred dollars. I will correct the rate, not reduce the recorded hours to force the same total.

05 **Amal:** The partner line totals two thousand for four hours. One hour appears duplicated, but I do not want to delete a genuine separate task on appearance alone.

06 **Theo:** Counsel has checked the underlying entries and confirmed a [3] _____. Removing that one hour leaves three hours at five hundred, or fifteen hundred.

Conversation / continued

07 **Amal:** So the two corrections are separate: three hundred for the associate rate and five hundred for the duplicate. The allowed expense is still one hundred fifty.

08 **Theo:** Correct. The [4] _____ should total five thousand two hundred fifty. That is eight hundred less than the original six thousand fifty, without changing the allowed expense.

09 **Amal:** Please retain the original invoice number and identify how the replacement relates to it. Accounts payable must not treat both versions as separate bills to pay.

10 **Theo:** I will follow our correction process and reference the superseded version. The corrected lines will show what changed; we will not simply send an unexplained lower total.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Review the bill line by line

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Amal:** One description combines a call, document review, and drafting into a single time entry. Our billing guidelines require separate tasks. Can counsel supply the actual breakdown?

12 **Theo:** I will query that [5] _____. We should obtain the recorded detail, not invent equal fractions for each task because the total happens to reconcile.

13 **Amal:** That clarification may affect review status. The arithmetic correction alone does not prove that every service description meets the client's billing requirements.

14 **Theo:** Understood. We will keep the narrative query open and distinguish the corrected amount from a fully cleared invoice. Any further adjustment needs its own supported basis.

15 **Amal:** For the reporting dashboard, I will label the eight hundred as a proposed invoice reduction until the corrected bill is accepted. It is not money already recovered.

16 **Theo:** And the [6] _____ still needs to approve payment. Your review documents the discrepancies and reconciliation, rather than replacing that approval.

17 **Amal:** Exactly. I will send the rate comparison, confirmed duplicate, expense support, and outstanding narrative question together so the reviewer sees the whole position.

18 **Theo:** I will return the linked corrected invoice and response through the agreed billing channel. We can then reconcile the payable record without losing the original history.

19 **Amal:** Our read-back is five thousand two hundred fifty on the stated corrections, with the task breakdown still being clarified and payment approval outstanding.

20 **Theo:** Agreed. I will not mark it paid or fully approved merely because the corrected arithmetic now matches the engagement rates.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. engagement terms / **2.** rate adjustment / **3.** duplicate entry / **4.** revised invoice / **5.** block billing / **6.** matter owner

Why these answers fit, page 178

Separate rate and duplicate corrections

Agreed rate $200/hour. An invoice bills ten hours at $220, including two confirmed duplicate hours, plus an allowed $100 expense. No tax or discount. Correct the rate on all ten hours first, then remove duplicates at the agreed rate. Payment approval is outstanding.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

200 / 400 / 1700 / approval

01 **Analyst:** The rate correction alone reduces the bill by $[1] _____ .

02 **Coordinator:** Removing the two duplicates at the agreed rate reduces it by another $ [2] _____ .

03 **Analyst:** Eight valid hours plus the expense produce a corrected total of $[3] _____ .

04 **Coordinator:** Correct arithmetic does not establish payment [4] _____ .

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 200 / **2.** 400 / **3.** 1700 / **4.** approval

Why these answers fit, page 178

Keep the distinction audible

Challenge a billing discrepancy precisely while separating proposed adjustments from payment authorization.

Language for the next case

Preserve before deletion

preservation

Preservation means protecting the relevant information from loss or alteration; an active email hold alone does not establish that chat and shared files are protected.

Sam: The email hold is active, but chat and shared files are still being configured. I will not mark preservation complete across all three sources just because the first system is covered.

custodian list

The custodian list identifies the people whose relevant records fall within the supplied hold; names and accounts must be matched rather than assuming one mailbox covers every source.

Sam: I need to confirm the custodian list against actual accounts and locations. The departing employee's chat identity differs from the email username, so that mapping needs attention.

deletion suspension

Deletion suspension stops the relevant scheduled removal within the hold's scope; sending a notice or opening a ticket is not evidence that the technical protection is effective.

Sam: I will coordinate the necessary deletion suspension and verify its effect. I will report any source we cannot protect in time to counsel promptly, not leave an unanswered ticket overnight.

acknowledgment

An acknowledgment confirms receipt or the specified response to a hold notice; it does not prove technical preservation or resolve missing responses from other custodians.

Sam: That is misleading. An acknowledgment is one part of follow-through. It is not a substitute for system verification or a reason to ignore the three outstanding responses.

scope

The scope defines the relevant subject, custodians, dates, and sources; uncertainty about another location requires clarification rather than unauthorized collection or silent exclusion.

Sam: Yes. The scope comes from counsel. If we discover a relevant shared workspace outside the current mapping, we should raise it rather than silently exclude it.

hold release

A hold release requires the authorized legal decision in this scenario; an expected settlement date does not end preservation or override another applicable hold or retention duty.

Sam: No. We need an authorized hold release. Counsel must confirm release, and we must check for other holds or retention requirements before resuming the relevant deletion process.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Preserve before deletion

Fictional hold H27: preserve named custodians' relevant Project Cedar email, chat, and shared files from 1 March onward, including new material. Chat deletion is tonight; one custodian leaves tomorrow. Counsel owns scope and release; IT implements and verifies protection. Some acknowledgments are missing.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

custodian list / scope / acknowledgment / deletion suspension / hold release / preservation

01 **Leah:** Counsel issued H27 this morning. Project Cedar chat is due for routine deletion tonight, and one named employee leaves tomorrow. Which preservation steps are actually in place?

02 **Sam:** The email hold is active, but chat and shared files are still being configured. I will not mark [1] _____ complete across all three sources just because the first system is covered.

03 **Leah:** The notice covers relevant material from March first onward, including new records. It is not a snapshot ending today.

04 **Sam:** I need to confirm the [2] _____ against actual accounts and locations. The departing employee's chat identity differs from the email username, so that mapping needs attention.

05 **Leah:** Please contact the responsible administrators now. Confirm scoped protection before tonight's deletion and tomorrow's departure processes run.

06 **Sam:** I will coordinate the necessary [3] _____ and verify its effect. I will report any source we cannot protect in time to counsel promptly, not leave an unanswered ticket overnight.

Conversation / continued

07 **Leah:** The departure workflow normally removes access and later deletes the account. We still need to protect records without leaving the employee authorized to use company systems.

08 **Sam:** Those are separate settings. We can arrange authorized access removal while retaining the scoped records. I will check the platform-specific behavior instead of assuming disabling an account preserves everything.

09 **Leah:** Three acknowledgments are missing. The dashboard colors the whole matter green because most are back.

10 **Sam:** That is misleading. An [4] _____ is one part of follow-through. It is not a substitute for system verification or a reason to ignore the three outstanding responses.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Preserve before deletion

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Leah:** I will follow up through the approved route and tell counsel about any missing person or source. Employees should identify relevant locations without collecting from accounts they cannot access.

12 **Sam:** Yes. The [5] _____ comes from counsel. If we discover a relevant shared workspace outside the current mapping, we should raise it rather than silently exclude it.

13 **Leah:** Can you send the preserved material directly to the other side once the hold is confirmed? That would save another handoff later.

14 **Sam:** No. Preserving information does not authorize its disclosure. Collection, relevance and privilege review, and any production must follow the legal team's instructions and permissions.

15 **Leah:** Understood. For today's status, I need each source, responsible administrator, action taken, verification result, and any unresolved limitation, with actual timestamps.

16 **Sam:** I will provide that record and distinguish a requested setting change from a verified one. If something was already deleted, I will state that fact and escalate recovery options without promising restoration.

17 **Leah:** The business expects settlement next week. Should we schedule the hold to disappear automatically on Friday if nobody contacts us?

18 **Sam:** No. We need an authorized [6] _____. Counsel must confirm release, and we must check for other holds or retention requirements before resuming the relevant deletion process.

19 **Leah:** Then the immediate priorities are chat protection, the departing custodian's records, the remaining sources, and the missing acknowledgments, all kept separately visible.

20 **Sam:** Agreed. I will send verified status and unresolved risks today. The record will show what is protected, not merely what we have asked people to do.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. preservation / **2.** custodian list / **3.** deletion suspension / **4.** acknowledgment / **5.** scope / **6.** hold release

Why these answers fit, page 180

An account can close while records remain

Hold H44 covers relevant email and chat for employee Jo. Jo leaves tomorrow. Email preservation is verified; chat protection is requested but unverified. Counsel has not released H44. Jo's access must end through the authorized departure process.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

chat / records / email / release

01 **Coordinator:** Verified preservation currently covers [1] _____ only.

02 **Administrator:** The unresolved source requiring urgent follow-through is [2] _____ .

03 **Coordinator:** Ending Jo's access is distinct from deleting Jo's [3] _____ .

04 **Administrator:** The departure itself does not authorize a hold [4] _____ .

CHECK THE GAPS

1. email / **2.** chat / **3.** records / **4.** release

Why these answers fit, page 180

Keep the distinction audible

Coordinate a scoped legal hold across people and systems without confusing acknowledgment, preservation, and disclosure.

Language for the next case

Send the right notice

notice clause

The notice clause specifies receipt at the designated address by 31 October at 17:00 UTC; an informal email to a salesperson is not confirmed compliance with those supplied terms.

Celia: Check the notice clause. The contract specifies a different recipient and a receipt deadline. Your sales email is not confirmed compliant notice.

approval requirement

The supplied internal approval requirement remains unmet; the department's decision does not by itself establish the authorized signatory's approval.

Celia: That approval requirement remains outstanding. Contact the signatory through the urgent route today; department approval does not cover every step.

receipt

Receipt concerns the notice reaching the specified recipient under the clause; an intention to forward or a sent-message record alone does not establish that event.

Celia: Keep the forwarding assurance as part of the history, not proof of receipt. We need the approved notice delivered through the specified route and evidence relevant to the actual receipt condition.

non-renewal

Non-renewal prevents the next contract term under the applicable terms, whereas ending service before the current term expires would be a different termination question.

Celia: That is non-renewal, not immediate termination. The wording should preserve the current term through November without requesting an earlier stop.

notice deadline

The notice deadline is 31 October at 17:00 UTC, distinct from the current term ending on 30 November; using the term end would miss the supplied notice requirement.

Celia: No. The notice deadline is in October. The term end belongs in a separate field. One controls the notice action; the other identifies when this service period finishes.

Remaining obligations

Remaining obligations can include the current term's agreed charges and other contractual duties; a non-renewal notice does not automatically waive them or establish a final settlement.

Celia: Not on that basis alone. Remaining obligations need their own review. Non-renewal is not automatically a fee waiver or confirmation that every account balance is settled.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Send the right notice

Fictional contract: term ends 30 November, otherwise renews one year. Non-renewal must reach notices@vendor.example by 31 October, 17:00 UTC. Internal signatory approval is required. A salesperson received an informal email yesterday; today is 29 October. These are supplied terms, not general legal rules.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

receipt / non-renewal / notice deadline / notice clause / approval requirement / Remaining obligations

01 **Ravi:** I emailed our sales contact yesterday: no additional year. Can you close the reminder, or is something else needed?

02 **Celia:** Check the [1] _____. The contract specifies a different recipient and a receipt deadline. Your sales email is not confirmed compliant notice.

03 **Ravi:** We want service through November thirtieth, but no additional year. I am not asking to stop service this week.

04 **Celia:** That is [2] _____, not immediate termination. The wording should preserve the current term through November without requesting an earlier stop.

05 **Ravi:** My department approved the decision. The checklist also requires the authorized signatory's approval, which I do not yet have.

06 **Celia:** That [3] _____ remains outstanding. Contact the signatory through the urgent route today; department approval does not cover every step.

Conversation / continued

07 **Ravi:** The notice must reach notices at vendor dot example by October thirty-first at seventeen hundred UTC. Should I enter the end of November as the deadline instead?

08 **Celia:** No. The [4] _____ is in October. The term end belongs in a separate field. One controls the notice action; the other identifies when this service period finishes.

09 **Ravi:** The account manager said they would forward my message. I have no confirmation that it reached the specified mailbox.

10 **Celia:** Keep the forwarding assurance as part of the history, not proof of [5] _____. We need the approved notice delivered through the specified route and evidence relevant to the actual receipt condition.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Send the right notice

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ravi:** What should the formal message identify so the vendor does not apply it to another agreement? We have two services with similar product names.

12 **Celia:** Use the correct contracting entity, agreement identifier, intended non-renewal, and current term end, with the approved wording and signatory process. Preserve the final version and its supporting record.

13 **Ravi:** I will ask the signatory today and prepare the approved notice. If the email bounces, we should not let the reminder close just because our system says sent.

14 **Celia:** Correct. Escalate a failed delivery immediately. Any alternative method or disputed interpretation needs legal review; we should not invent a replacement route and call it contractually equivalent.

15 **Ravi:** Once the vendor acknowledges the notice, can I describe this as cancellation with nothing more to pay? Finance is asking about the remaining service charges.

16 **Celia:** Not on that basis alone. [6] _____ need their own review. Non-renewal is not automatically a fee waiver or confirmation that every account balance is settled.

17 **Ravi:** Then the handoff to finance should say current term continues to November thirtieth, with the notice and final charges tracked separately.

18 **Celia:** Yes. Keep service continuity, notice status, and any exit duties visible. The business decision and operational offboarding plan are related, but neither substitutes for the notice evidence.

19 **Ravi:** I will leave the task open until we have the required approval, final message, delivery record, and confirmation appropriate to the receipt clause.

20 **Celia:** Good. We can then record the supported status and archive the evidence without rewriting yesterday's informal email as something it has not been shown to accomplish.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. notice clause / **2.** non-renewal / **3.** approval requirement / **4.** notice deadline / **5.** receipt / **6.** Remaining obligations

Why these answers fit, page 182

Do not substitute the term-end date

Fictional terms: current service ends 31 August. Non-renewal notice must reach renewals@provider.example by 31 July at 12:00 UTC. Approved notice sent to that address bounced. No alternative delivery method has been confirmed. The business wants service through August.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

12:00 / reminder / non-renewal / receipt

01 **Owner:** The intended action is [1] _____, not immediate termination.

02 **Administrator:** The specified notice deadline is 31 July at [2] _____ UTC.

03 **Owner:** The bounced email does not establish [3] _____ .

04 **Administrator:** We must urgently resolve delivery rather than close the [4] _____ .

CHECK THE GAPS

1. non-renewal / **2.** 12:00 / **3.** receipt / **4.** reminder

Why these answers fit, page 182

Keep the distinction audible

Distinguish non-renewal, termination, dispatch, and receipt under an explicit notice clause.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which information is missing from intake?

D. Agreement type, business owner, and required decision date

The request lacks routing essentials even though a proposal and earlier nondisclosure agreement are attached.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. What does the service proposal describe?

A. A two-month software pilot for $40,000

The attachment describes the proposed pilot, while signature and approval remain unconfirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What can Mina do?

A. Coordinate triage and route the request

Mina's role concerns coordination, not the unconfirmed commercial or legal decision authorities.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which acknowledgment is accurate?

D. L17 is received; routing information and required approvals remain outstanding.

Receipt and document presence do not establish review, spending approval, or execution authority.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which question clarifies timing best?

B. What decision is needed by which date, and how does that differ from desired signature?

A specific decision and consequence distinguish the review need from signature, supplier pressure, and an unsupported duration estimate.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The person accountable for the underlying business need. Which term fits?

B. business owner

A Not here. signature authority: Permission to execute the relevant agreement on behalf of a party. The usual combination is "verify signature authority".

B Correct. business owner: The person accountable for the underlying business need. The usual combination is "identify the business owner".

C Not here. CLM: Contract lifecycle management; processes and systems for managing contract stages. The usual combination is "maintain the CLM record".

D Not here. NDA: Nondisclosure agreement; terms governing specified confidential information. The usual combination is "locate the NDA".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction". Ben: "I submitted it for Nell in operations. She owns the pilot objective, although I do not know who approves the final spend." Mina: [missing response] Ben: "The slides say Orbit; the proposal has a longer company name. I nearly shortened it to match. Should I leave it as written?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I will record Nell as the business owner and leave the spend approver unconfirmed. The person who requests work, the person who owns the need, and the person who can authorize it are not necessarily the same.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Ben says: "The proposal is for a two-month pilot costing forty thousand dollars. I attached the confidentiality agreement we signed earlier as well." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Ben says: "The pilot will use customer contact details. I am not sure whether the supplier only views them or also stores a copy." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 6. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. Nell owns the business need, while spending and signature authority still require separate confirmation.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Ben says: "The slides say Orbit; the proposal has a longer company name. I nearly shortened it to match. Should I leave it as written?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. intake

Turn 2. Intake gathers the routing information; receiving an attachment does not establish legal or commercial approval.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. NDA

Turn 4. The NDA concerns specified confidential information and does not automatically approve the separate pilot services arrangement.

3. business owner

Turn 6. Nell owns the business need, while spending and signature authority still require separate confirmation.

4. legal entity

Turn 8. The legal entity identifies the proposed contracting party; a brand name may not identify that party accurately.

5. decision deadline

Turn 10. The decision is needed on 6 October at noon UTC, separately from the desired 9 October signature.

6. review scope

Turn 12. The review scope must flag the unresolved data handling so an appropriate specialist can assess the actual arrangement.

7. version control

Turn 14. Version control identifies the current proposal and changes; neither unsigned revision should be presented as executed.

8. signature authority

Turn 16. Signature authority must be confirmed separately; legal review does not automatically authorize the requester to execute the agreement.

9. turnaround estimate

Turn 18. A turnaround estimate needs the relevant scope and reviewer capacity; supplier pressure alone does not justify today's completion promise.

10. triage

Turn 20. Triage determines the appropriate route, priority, and next action without deciding the contract's substantive legal or commercial terms.

Return to the conversation, page 10

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What should the reviewer receive?

A. The current proposal, referenced terms, party details, business purpose, and relevant data information

The complete relevant package supports review without substituting an incomplete or misleading description.

Return to the exercise, page 14

F2. Which distinction is necessary?

A. Requester, business owner, spend approver, and signer may be different roles.

These roles and stages can differ, so authority must be established rather than inferred.

Return to the exercise, page 14

F / Guided speaking

1. unsigned

Coordinator: The document status is unsigned.

Turn 1. The proposal has not been executed in the supplied record.

2. Dana

Requester: The business owner is Dana.

Turn 2. Dana owns the need, which does not automatically establish every approval authority.

3. 5 May

Coordinator: The decision is needed on 5 May.

Turn 3. The review decision date differs from the desired signature date of 9 May.

4. unconfirmed

Requester: The signer remains unconfirmed.

Turn 4. No authorized signer has been identified, so the requester cannot assume that role.

Return to the conversation, page 15

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction". Ben: "There are two versions of the proposal in the email chain. The latest changes the support arrangement, but neither is signed." Mina: [missing response] Ben: "Once the legal team reviews it, can I send it for signature, or should I wait for another approval?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep clear version control. Identify the current revision and preserve the relevant history so the reviewer sees the changed support terms rather than an outdated attachment.

A Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 14. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. Version control identifies the current proposal and changes; neither unsigned revision should be presented as executed.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Ben says: "I marked L17 urgent. The supplier is waiting, and the business wants the software pilot moving this week." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Ben says: "Once the legal team reviews it, can I send it for signature, or should I wait for another approval?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Ben says: "I will get Nell's confirmation, the party details, the latest proposal, and the data-handling information into the same record." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 15

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What triggers the stated H3 preapproval requirement?

A. More than $100 per guest before commitment

H3 uses a per-guest threshold above one hundred dollars and requires approval before commitment.

Return to the exercise, page 17

A2. What is the proposed cost per guest?

B. $120

Nine hundred sixty divided by eight equals one hundred twenty dollars per guest.

Return to the exercise, page 17

A3. What is missing from implementation?

B. An assigned check operator and evidence-retention arrangements

H3 has been published, but the operational ownership and evidence arrangements remain undefined.

Return to the exercise, page 17

D / Response choices

D1. Which status statement is accurate?

A. H3 is published, but the control is not yet fully assigned or evidenced.

Publication does not establish operational ownership or completed checks, and H3 uses a per-guest basis.

Return to the exercise, page 21

D2. Which event statement matches the rule?

A. The $120-per-guest proposal requires preapproval before commitment.

The per-guest cost exceeds the stated threshold, and the absence of commitment preserves the required review sequence.

Return to the exercise, page 21

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The intended result of a control. Which term fits?

C. control objective

A Not here. detective control: A control intended to identify an event or condition after or as it occurs. The usual combination is "operate a detective control".

B Not here. evidence repository: The approved location for maintaining supporting records. The usual combination is "use the evidence repository".

C Correct. control objective: The intended result of a control. The usual combination is "define the control objective".

D Not here. operating effectiveness: Whether a control works as intended in practice over the relevant scope. The usual combination is "test operating effectiveness".

Return to the exercise, page 21

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The policy is published, but the check has no owner". Dinesh: "The estimate is nine hundred sixty dollars for eight guests, including all charges. Someone thought the total had to exceed a thousand." Mara: [missing response] Dinesh: "We can check the information on receipt, but my team should not be deciding whether the hospitality is permissible." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The threshold is per guest. Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty, so this proposal triggers compliance review. That calculation does not itself approve the event.

A Correct. This is Mara's response in turn 6. It connects Dinesh's preceding point with Dinesh's follow-up. H3 uses more than one hundred dollars per guest, not a thousand-dollar total-event threshold.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Dinesh says: "What happens if a requester says the booking cannot wait and the usual reviewer is unavailable?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Dinesh says: "We normally check receipts after the meal. For this one, nothing is booked. Where should our check sit before somebody commits the money?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Dinesh says: "We can check the information on receipt, but my team should not be deciding whether the hospitality is permissible." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 21

E / Conversation

1. control operator

Turn 2. The control operator performs the defined check; publishing H3 has not assigned that practical responsibility.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. preapproval

Turn 4. Preapproval must occur before commitment under H3; an after-the-event receipt check does not fulfill that timing requirement.

3. threshold

Turn 6. H3 uses more than one hundred dollars per guest, not a thousand-dollar total-event threshold.

4. approver

Turn 8. The approver holds the relevant decision authority, which is distinct from checking intake completeness and arithmetic.

5. control evidence

Turn 10. Control evidence links the request, relevant calculation, authorized decision, reviewer, and timing to the actual event.

6. evidence repository

Turn 12. The evidence repository provides an authorized location for the linked records under applicable access and retention rules.

7. issue escalation

Turn 14. Issue escalation routes urgency to the designated alternative authority; it does not grant the requester permission to bypass the control.

8. control trigger

Turn 16. The stated trigger concerns one preapproval requirement; other restrictions can still apply below the amount threshold.

9. design effectiveness

Turn 18. Design effectiveness concerns whether the proposed control addresses its objective, not proof that it operated throughout past periods.

10. Operating effectiveness

Turn 20. Operating effectiveness requires evidence that the control actually worked as intended within the relevant scope and period.

Return to the conversation, page 23

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which evidence is most useful?

A. The identified request, calculation, authorized decision, and timestamps showing the sequence

The linked records allow review of both the decision and whether it occurred before the relevant commitment.

Return to the exercise, page 27

F2. What does a well-written procedure prove by itself?

D. The designed steps, not that they operated effectively in practice

Design documentation explains the intended process, while operation and effectiveness require separate evidence.

Return to the exercise, page 27

F / Guided speaking

1. $90

Coordinator: The proposed cost per guest is $90.

Turn 1. Five hundred forty divided by six equals ninety dollars per guest.

2. $80 threshold

Reviewer: That exceeds the stated $80 threshold.

Turn 2. Ninety is above eighty, so the stated preapproval trigger applies.

3. commitment

Coordinator: Approval is required before commitment.

Turn 3. The fictional rule defines a preventive sequence, not only an after-event review.

4. not approved

Reviewer: The current approval status is not approved.

Turn 4. No approval is recorded, and exceeding the threshold triggers review rather than automatic permission.

Return to the conversation, page 28

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The policy is published, but the check has no owner". Dinesh: "What happens if a requester says the booking cannot wait and the usual reviewer is unavailable?" Mara: [missing response] Dinesh: "Should every amount below one hundred dollars be marked approved automatically?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Define the issue escalation and cover arrangement. Urgency does not let the requester approve their own exception or split the event into smaller claims to make the threshold disappear.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Dinesh says: "We can check the information on receipt, but my team should not be deciding whether the hospitality is permissible." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Mara's response in turn 14. It connects Dinesh's preceding point with Dinesh's follow-up. Issue escalation routes urgency to the designated alternative authority; it does not grant the requester permission to bypass the control.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Dinesh says: "We normally check receipts after the meal. For this one, nothing is booked. Where should our check sit before somebody commits the money?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Dinesh says: "The estimate is nine hundred sixty dollars for eight guests, including all charges. Someone thought the total had to exceed a thousand." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 28

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which period did Talia request?

D. January through March 2026

The request concerns three named historical months rather than the current configuration alone.

Return to the exercise, page 31

A2. Which review packages have been found?

B. January and February

The brief states that two packages are located while March remains missing.

Return to the exercise, page 31

A3. What does the April screenshot establish by itself?

D. The displayed current setting, not completion of all three historical reviews

A current setting image does not document whether the requested historical activities actually occurred.

Return to the exercise, page 31

D / Response choices

D1. Which submission description is accurate?

B. January and February packages are available; March remains an identified evidence gap.

The known record availability supports a bounded description, not historical completeness or a fabricated record.

Return to the exercise, page 35

D2. Which question best tests the screenshot's relevance?

B. Does this current setting image show that the requested historical reviews actually occurred?

The image shows current configuration; it does not by itself establish historical configuration, completed reviews, or a complete quarterly evidence set.

Return to the exercise, page 35

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The time interval covered by an assessment. Which term fits?

A. review period

A Correct. review period: The time interval covered by an assessment. The usual combination is "state the review period".

B Not here. completeness: Whether all required or relevant items are included on the stated basis. The usual combination is "assess completeness".

C Not here. reperformance: Independently carrying out a procedure to check its result. The usual combination is "document reperformance".

D Not here. source record: The originating record used as evidence. The usual combination is "preserve source records".

Return to the exercise, page 35

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A current screenshot does not answer a historical question". Talia: "That distinction matters. I need evidence of operation during the requested months, not only evidence that a review feature is currently enabled." Hugo: [missing response] Talia: "What is included in the two packages you have located? We need to understand how they connect to the control activity." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Understood. The review period remains January through March 2026. I will label the April image separately so it cannot be mistaken for a historical review record.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Talia says: "Please be careful not to turn the missing March package into an unsupported conclusion about whether the review occurred." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Talia says: "Do you have an index showing the requested months and the status of each item?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Talia says: "I also have a screenshot marked review enabled. When was it taken? I do not want to mistake a current setting for a completed monthly check." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Hugo's response in turn 6. It connects Talia's preceding point with Talia's follow-up. The review period is January through March 2026, which determines whether the submitted records answer the request.

Return to the exercise, page 35

E / Conversation

1. review packages

Turn 2. The located packages cover two requested months; the March package has not yet been found.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. timestamp

Turn 4. The screenshot was captured on 2 April, so its current configuration view is not evidence of all earlier review events.

3. review period

Turn 6. The review period is January through March 2026, which determines whether the submitted records answer the request.

4. source record

Turn 8. Source records connect the package to the originating activity and must be checked rather than inferred from a file title.

5. completeness

Turn 10. Completeness is checked against the defined requested items; two located files cannot silently stand for three months.

6. evidence gap

Turn 12. An evidence gap identifies missing support without by itself proving that the underlying March review did not occur.

7. retrospective account

Turn 14. A retrospective account is a later explanation and must retain its actual date and source rather than impersonate an original sign-off.

8. redactions

Turn 16. Authorized redactions protect information while preserving transparency about any effect on the evidence available for assessment.

9. audit trail

Turn 18. The audit trail records the search, sources, changes, and follow-up without altering the original evidence or its history.

10. management response

Turn 20. The management response should state the available evidence, unresolved gap, and next action rather than claim unsupported historical completion.

Return to the conversation, page 37

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. How should a later employee explanation be handled?

C. Label its source and actual date and assess what it supports.

A retrospective account can be useful but must retain its identity and evidential limitations.

Return to the exercise, page 39

F2. What does two packages out of three establish?

D. Current evidence availability for two requested months

Record availability alone does not calculate overall control effectiveness or establish the missing month's substantive result.

Return to the exercise, page 39

F / Guided speaking

1. April through June

Owner: The requested period is April through June.

Turn 1. The audit concerns three historical months, not only the current July setting.

2. June

Auditor: The missing package is June.

Turn 2. April and May are available, leaving June as the stated gap.

3. 3 July

Owner: The screenshot date is 3 July.

Turn 3. The image's date identifies a later current-state view rather than a June review record.

4. nonperformance

Auditor: The gap alone does not prove nonperformance.

Turn 4. A missing package does not by itself establish that the underlying activity never occurred.

Return to the conversation, page 40

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A current screenshot does not answer a historical question". Talia: "If the reviewer remembers doing it, send that account too. Just keep its actual date visible; it cannot become the missing March sign-off." Hugo: [missing response] Talia: "Some records contain user details. Follow the approved sharing process, but make clear if any removal limits what I can assess." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Any retrospective account will have its actual creation date and author. We will not recreate a sign-off and date it in March merely to make the index look complete.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Talia says: "What is included in the two packages you have located? We need to understand how they connect to the control activity." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Hugo's response in turn 14. It connects Talia's preceding point with Talia's follow-up. A retrospective account is a later explanation and must retain its actual date and source rather than impersonate an original sign-off.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Talia says: "The request covers monthly privileged-access reviews for January through March. Can you confirm which records your submission will include?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Talia says: "Do you have an index showing the requested months and the status of each item?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 40

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What does Elena say she observed?

A. V19 marked approved while the receiving field was blank

The reported observation concerns an invoice status and blank field, not a witnessed payoff.

Return to the exercise, page 42

A2. What is the current status of the suspected motive?

B. An allegation or inference that has not been established

The payoff interpretation is not supported by a witnessed payment or completed review in the supplied facts.

Return to the exercise, page 42

A3. What additional concern requires recording?

C. Elena fears adverse shift changes after reporting.

The stated fear concerns possible retaliation and must remain distinct from both the transaction allegation and a proven event.

Return to the exercise, page 42

D / Response choices

D1. Which intake sentence is neutral and useful?

C. Elena reports seeing V19 approved with a blank receiving field and suspects a payoff.

The sentence preserves the reported observation and interpretation while avoiding an unsupported finding.

Return to the exercise, page 46

D2. What should a reviewer do with alternative explanations?

A. Assess relevant supporting and contradictory evidence under the authorized scope.

Fair assessment considers relevant evidence without prejudgment or unauthorized evidence gathering.

Return to the exercise, page 46

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A conclusion reached through an authorized assessment of evidence. Which term fits?

B. finding

A Not here. investigation scope: The defined questions and boundaries of an inquiry. The usual combination is "establish investigation scope".

B Correct. finding: A conclusion reached through an authorized assessment of evidence. The usual combination is "substantiate a finding".

C Not here. retaliation concern: A concern about adverse treatment because of reporting or another protected activity. The usual combination is "record a retaliation concern".

D Not here. contradictory evidence: Information that conflicts with a claim or interpretation. The usual combination is "assess contradictory evidence".

Return to the exercise, page 46

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding". Elena: "I read the empty field as goods not received. That was my assumption; I did not check with receiving." Noah: [missing response] Elena: "A colleague may have seen the same screen. Should I ask them to agree with my account before you take it further?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. That is an inference we should identify. A blank field may need explanation, but it does not by itself establish nonreceipt, improper approval, or a payment to your manager.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Elena says: "I saw V19 marked approved on the twenty-seventh of September, but the receiving field was blank. I think my manager is getting a payoff." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Elena says: "I have my own notes and a message about the invoice. I have not changed them or accessed anyone else's account." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Elena says: "A colleague may have seen the same screen. Should I ask them to agree with my account before you take it further?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Noah's response in turn 6. It connects Elena's preceding point with Elena's follow-up. A blank field does not itself establish nonreceipt; Elena inferred that meaning without confirming the receiving facts.

Return to the exercise, page 46

E / Conversation

1. reported observation

Turn 2. The reported observation concerns the invoice status and blank field; it remains attributed until the relevant evidence is reviewed.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. allegation

Turn 4. The payoff is an allegation, not an established fact or something Elena says she directly witnessed.

3. inference

Turn 6. A blank field does not itself establish nonreceipt; Elena inferred that meaning without confirming the receiving facts.

4. corroboration

Turn 8. Corroboration should come from independently assessed evidence, not from asking another person to align their account.

5. chronology

Turn 10. The chronology should preserve known dates and uncertain times rather than inserting a guess as a precise fact.

6. preservation

Turn 12. Preservation protects relevant existing material from loss or alteration through the authorized process, not unauthorized collection.

7. confidentiality

Turn 14. Confidentiality concerns restricted authorized handling; it is not a guarantee that no other person will need the information.

8. conflict of interest

Turn 16. A possible conflict must be assessed when assigning the reviewer so the concern is not handled through an inappropriate or compromised route.

9. retaliation concern

Turn 18. The fear of adverse shift changes is a separate concern, not a statement that a shift change has already occurred.

10. case handoff

Turn 20. The handoff must preserve the observation, interpretation, unknowns, and separate retaliation concern for the authorized reviewer.

Return to the conversation, page 48

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which confidentiality statement is appropriate?

D. The report will follow restricted authorized handling, but absolute secrecy cannot be promised.

Controlled handling and clear limits are more accurate than absolute secrecy, automatic privilege, or broad disclosure.

Return to the exercise, page 51

F2. How should the shift concern be handled?

D. Record it as a separate concern and route it through the appropriate process.

The concern warrants documented routing without a guarantee or a conflicted decision path.

Return to the exercise, page 51

F / Guided speaking

1. reported observation

Coordinator: Rosa's account of the screen is a reported observation.

Turn 1. The screen account is attributed to Rosa and has not yet been independently established.

2. allegation

Reporter: The suspected personal benefit is an allegation.

Turn 2. Rosa did not witness a personal payment, so the suspected benefit is not a finding.

3. nondelivery

Coordinator: The blank field does not prove nondelivery.

Turn 3. Missing field completion does not by itself establish whether goods were delivered.

4. unreviewed

Reporter: The transaction context remains unreviewed.

Turn 4. The relevant context has not yet been assessed, so conclusions about propriety remain premature.

Return to the conversation, page 52

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding". Elena: "Can you guarantee that my manager will never learn that I contacted you? I am worried about how this could affect my work." Noah: [missing response] Elena: "The manager is close to someone on the usual review team. I am concerned that the report could go straight back to them." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I can explain our confidentiality process, but I cannot promise absolute secrecy. Information needs controlled handling by the appropriate people, and some details may need to be shared for a fair review.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Elena says: "A colleague may have seen the same screen. Should I ask them to agree with my account before you take it further?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Elena says: "I remember the date clearly, although I would need to check my notes for the time. I do not want to guess." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Noah's response in turn 14. It connects Elena's preceding point with Elena's follow-up. Confidentiality concerns restricted authorized handling; it is not a guarantee that no other person will need the information.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Elena says: "I saw V19 marked approved on the twenty-seventh of September, but the receiving field was blank. I think my manager is getting a payoff." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 52

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What two actions does the message request?

B. Access to information and deletion of contact details

The original wording asks both what is held and deletion of contact details, so the actions must be distinguished.

Return to the exercise, page 56

A2. Why is identity clarification needed here?

D. The unfamiliar address and name do not securely identify the relevant account.

The facts create a genuine matching uncertainty, not a universal requirement for a specific document.

Return to the exercise, page 56

A3. What should be preserved at intake?

C. The original wording and 1 October 09:00 UTC receipt time

Accurate receipt and wording preserve the request history and support appropriate timing and scope assessment.

Return to the exercise, page 56

D / Response choices

D1. Which initial response is appropriate?

A. Log both requested actions and arrange necessary identity clarification through the approved route.

The response recognizes the request while addressing the real identity uncertainty and preserving both actions.

Return to the exercise, page 60

D2. Which identity approach is proportionate?

A. Request only information needed to resolve the actual uncertainty under the approved process.

Verification must address the present matching uncertainty without a universal document rule, a guessed match, or unnecessary collection.

Return to the exercise, page 60

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Data subject access request; another common term for a personal-data access request. Which term fits?

B. DSAR

A Not here. response deadline: The due date determined under the applicable rules and facts. The usual combination is "verify the response deadline".

B Correct. DSAR: Data subject access request; another common term for a personal-data access request. The usual combination is "route a DSAR".

C Not here. exemption: A legally applicable qualification or exception requiring case-specific assessment. The usual combination is "assess an exemption".

D Not here. authorized representative: A person whose authority to act for another has been established. The usual combination is "verify representative authority".

Return to the exercise, page 60

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record". Pia: "Our last case used a passport. Should I ask for one again, or first check what would resolve this particular account match?" Wen: [missing response] Pia: "I can explain that we need enough information to avoid sending somebody else's record. Should I ask the person to choose access or deletion?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Use data minimization. Request only what is necessary under the approved process to resolve the uncertainty. Formal identification is not automatically the right answer in every case, and unnecessary documents create their own handling risk.

A Correct. This is Wen's response in turn 6. It connects Pia's preceding point with Pia's follow-up. Data minimization limits additional collection to what is necessary for the verification purpose rather than demanding documents by default.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Pia says: "This message came in at zero nine hundred UTC on the first of October. It says send me what you hold about me and delete my contact details." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Pia says: "Could we complete the access part and promise that every matching record will then be deleted?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Pia says: "The system has a pause button for clarification. Should I use it now, or does the privacy team need to confirm the timing rule first?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 60

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. receipt timestamp

Turn 2. The original receipt timestamp preserves when the request arrived; later routing must not replace that history.

2. identity verification

Turn 4. Identity verification must resolve the genuine matching uncertainty proportionately before information is disclosed to a guessed account holder.

3. data minimization

Turn 6. Data minimization limits additional collection to what is necessary for the verification purpose rather than demanding documents by default.

4. request scope

Turn 8. The request scope includes access and deletion; neither should be silently removed or forced into a single action.

5. erasure request

Turn 10. An erasure request requires assessment under applicable rules, including relevant retention duties, rather than automatic deletion of every record.

6. jurisdiction

Turn 12. Jurisdiction and the relevant facts determine which legal rules apply; a remembered training example is not universal timing authority.

7. response deadline

Turn 14. Response timing and any permitted pause require the applicable legal assessment; a clarification message alone does not establish a universal pause.

8. authorized representative

Turn 16. A representative's authority must be established through the appropriate process before treating their instructions as the person's own.

9. third-party information

Turn 18. Information about other people requires the appropriate disclosure assessment; recognizing access rights does not authorize indiscriminate release.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. request log

Turn 20. The request log preserves the original request, dates, owner, actions, and unresolved questions so the case remains traceable.

Return to the conversation, page 62

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which timing statement is accurate for this case?

B. The applicable rules must be confirmed; internal routing alone does not establish a paused deadline.

No applicable legal timing rule is supplied, so staff must preserve dates and obtain the correct assessment.

Return to the exercise, page 65

F2. What should staff avoid when clarifying scope?

C. Silently turning the combined request into deletion only

Narrowing or changing the requested action without a proper basis misrepresents what the person asked.

Return to the exercise, page 65

F / Guided speaking

1. 14:20 UTC

Agent: The receipt time is 14:20 UTC.

Turn 1. The original arrival time belongs in the request history even while identity remains uncertain.

2. address correction

Coordinator: The second requested action is address correction.

Turn 2. The person asks to correct an address, not to delete all information.

3. identity clarification

Agent: Before disclosure, the account match requires identity clarification.

Turn 3. The current information does not securely identify the relevant person and account.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

4. to be confirmed

Coordinator: The applicable deadline remains to be confirmed.

Turn 4. No governing timing rule is supplied, so staff must track the request and obtain the appropriate assessment.

Return to the conversation, page 66

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record". Pia: "The system has a pause button for clarification. Should I use it now, or does the privacy team need to confirm the timing rule first?" Wen: [missing response] Pia: "The person may ask a family member to respond for them. How would that change the next step?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Do not assume that about the response deadline. Record the action and continue tracking dates unless the authorized assessment establishes the relevant timing treatment. An internal transfer is not permission to lose the original receipt date.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Pia says: "Could we complete the access part and promise that every matching record will then be deleted?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Pia says: "Our last case used a passport. Should I ask for one again, or first check what would resolve this particular account match?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Pia says: "This message came in at zero nine hundred UTC on the first of October. It says send me what you hold about me and delete my contact details." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Wen's response in turn 14. It connects Pia's preceding point with Pia's follow-up. Response timing and any permitted pause require the applicable legal assessment; a clarification message alone does not establish a universal pause.

Return to the exercise, page 66

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which proposed dataset is more detailed about individuals?

D. B's names, work emails, and salary records

B requests person-level identifiers and salary information, while A proposes counts at department level.

Return to the exercise, page 68

A2. What is unknown about B's subcontractors?

C. Their locations and access

The brief identifies hosting and support subcontractors but leaves their locations and access unconfirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 68

A3. What is the current approval status?

A. Neither vendor is approved.

The scenario explicitly leaves both approvals open pending relevant assessment.

Return to the exercise, page 68

D / Response choices

D1. Which comparison is justified?

C. B proposes more person-level data and unresolved downstream access, requiring relevant assessment.

Actual data detail and dependencies affect the assessment without proving automatic approval or rejection.

Return to the exercise, page 73

D2. What is a useful question about salary fields?

D. Are they necessary for the agreed reporting purpose, and who would access them?

The question connects collection and access to purpose rather than assuming every requested field is justified.

Return to the exercise, page 73

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Whether information is needed for the stated purpose. Which term fits?

B. data necessity

A Not here. risk acceptance: An authorized decision to take a defined risk under the relevant framework. The usual combination is "document risk acceptance".

B Correct. data necessity: Whether information is needed for the stated purpose. The usual combination is "assess data necessity".

C Not here. cross-border transfer: Movement or access to information across relevant national boundaries. The usual combination is "assess cross-border transfers".

D Not here. audit right: A contractual or other right to examine specified records or practices. The usual combination is "clarify audit rights".

Return to the exercise, page 73

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure". Paolo: "I just found two other companies in B's diagram: hosting and support. The arrows do not show whether support staff can read the salary records." Imani: [missing response] Paolo: "The sales team called them standard subcontractors. Does that description settle the question?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. We need the data flow and access roles. A diagram should show where the information is stored, who can reach it, and what each downstream provider does with it.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Paolo says: "B's demonstration was easier to use. Both vendors produce workforce reports, so I hoped the risk review could be the same for each." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Paolo says: "We have not been told where the hosting and support activities occur. Should I put our own country in the form for now?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Imani's response in turn 6. It connects Paolo's preceding point with Paolo's follow-up. The data flow should identify storage, access, movement, and downstream recipients, including the unconfirmed support access.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Paolo says: "We need department-level planning. A proposes counts by department, while B asks for employee names, work emails, and individual salaries." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 73

E / Conversation

1. business rationale

Turn 2. The business rationale defines the needed reporting outcome, which helps assess whether each vendor's proposed inputs are justified.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. data necessity

Turn 4. Data necessity asks whether each individual field is required for the stated department-planning purpose rather than merely requested by the vendor.

3. data flow

Turn 6. The data flow should identify storage, access, movement, and downstream recipients, including the unconfirmed support access.

4. subcontractor

Turn 8. A subcontractor label does not establish actual activities, access, locations, or the appropriate data-processing role.

5. cross-border transfers

Turn 10. Unconfirmed storage or access locations require assessment; staff must not insert an assumed country to complete a form.

6. inherent risk

Turn 12. Inherent risk still needs assessment of actual data, context, access, and use; department counts do not establish zero exposure.

7. security questionnaire

Turn 14. The questionnaire is a source of vendor claims to assess, not independent proof of every control or an approval decision.

8. contractual safeguards

Turn 16. Contractual safeguards address defined obligations, but their adequacy depends on the actual service, data roles, and applicable requirements.

9. risk acceptance

Turn 18. Risk acceptance is an authorized decision about defined remaining exposure, not permission created by an incomplete intake form.

10. ongoing monitoring

Turn 20. Ongoing monitoring checks material changes after initial assessment, including changes in data use and downstream dependencies.

Return to the conversation, page 75

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. How should a questionnaire be treated?

C. As one source to evaluate alongside relevant supporting evidence and gaps

Questionnaire responses require contextual assessment and do not automatically verify controls or confer approval.

Return to the exercise, page 79

F2. Who may accept an identified residual risk?

C. The designated authorized decision-maker under the actual framework

Risk acceptance requires defined authority and a recorded basis, not commercial enthusiasm or document receipt.

Return to the exercise, page 79

F / Guided speaking

1. access

Coordinator: The unresolved support issue is access.

Turn 1. The support provider's ability to reach the records has not been established.

2. business purpose

Owner: We must clarify the service's business purpose.

Turn 2. The required purpose helps determine which inputs and service features are actually necessary.

3. approved

Coordinator: Neither supplier is currently approved.

Turn 3. The brief leaves both vendor decisions open rather than favoring one automatically.

4. zero risk

Owner: A site-level-total label does not prove zero risk.

Turn 4. Data context, combinations, access, and other service risks still require assessment.

Return to the conversation, page 80

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure". Paolo: "B returned the questionnaire this morning. Purchasing is asking whether completed means cleared. What should I tell them is still outstanding?" Imani: [missing response] Paolo: "What should the agreement and operational plan cover beyond the questionnaire answers?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. The security questionnaire is one source of information. We still need relevant evidence, its scope and date, any exceptions, and the actual arrangements for this service.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Paolo says: "B's demonstration was easier to use. Both vendors produce workforce reports, so I hoped the risk review could be the same for each." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Paolo says: "If some uncertainty remains after those checks, can the business record it and decide whether to proceed?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Imani's response in turn 14. It connects Paolo's preceding point with Paolo's follow-up. The questionnaire is a source of vendor claims to assess, not independent proof of every control or an approval decision.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Paolo says: "We have not been told where the hosting and support activities occur. Should I put our own country in the form for now?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 80

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What does the 98% figure measure?

B. Recorded course completion among 500 assigned employees

Four hundred ninety divided by five hundred measures completion, not every aspect of knowledge or conduct.

Return to the exercise, page 84

A2. How many volunteers answered correctly?

C. Eight of twenty

The application check reports eight correct answers in the separate twenty-person volunteer group.

Return to the exercise, page 84

A3. What does W4 require for paid weekend work?

A. Disclosure before it begins

The fictional rule explicitly includes weekend work and requires prior disclosure without establishing automatic rejection.

Return to the exercise, page 84

D / Response choices

D1. Which headline is supported?

B. Training completion is 98%; a separate volunteer check identified an application gap.

The evidence supports a completion measure and a limited separate check, not universal behavior or motive claims.

Return to the exercise, page 88

D2. An employee plans paid weekend work. What does W4 require?

B. Disclosure before the work begins

The fictional rule covers weekend paid work and specifies prior disclosure, not an automatic prohibition.

Return to the exercise, page 88

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The condition used to mark an activity complete. Which term fits?

A. completion criterion

A Correct. completion criterion: The condition used to mark an activity complete. The usual combination is "define completion criteria".

B Not here. accessibility: The ability of people with varied needs to access and use the material. The usual combination is "check training accessibility".

C Not here. representativeness: How well a group reflects the population relevant to a conclusion. The usual combination is "assess representativeness".

D Not here. scenario-based assessment: An assessment using realistic situations to test defined decisions. The usual combination is "use scenario-based assessment".

Return to the exercise, page 88

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Completion is not the same as understanding". Sofia: "The application check tells a different story: eight correct answers from twenty volunteers. I cannot use the five-hundred-person denominator for that result." Ren: [missing response] Sofia: "Most questions were about paid weekend assignments. People thought the disclosure rule only concerned work during their normal hours." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That is forty percent in the volunteer sample. It identifies a concern worth addressing, but it does not establish that forty percent of the whole workforce understands the policy or that everyone else has failed.

A Correct. This is Ren's response in turn 6. It connects Sofia's preceding point with Sofia's follow-up. The volunteer sample contains twenty self-selected participants and is not established as representative of all assigned employees.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Sofia says: "Most questions were about paid weekend assignments. People thought the disclosure rule only concerned work during their normal hours." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Sofia says: "The learning dashboard shows ninety-eight percent completion. Our summary currently says the workforce is ninety-eight percent compliant." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Sofia says: "The course includes an acknowledgment at the end. Could we use that as evidence that everyone accepted the exact meaning of every example?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 88

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07 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. completion rate

Turn 2. The completion rate is 490 of 500 assigned employees, not a verified rate of compliant workplace behavior.

2. assigned cohort

Turn 4. The assigned cohort defines the completion denominator, while missing records and approved exceptions need accurate status handling.

3. volunteer sample

Turn 6. The volunteer sample contains twenty self-selected participants and is not established as representative of all assigned employees.

4. application gap

Turn 8. The application gap concerns whether the prior-disclosure rule includes paid weekend work, rather than course attendance alone.

5. acknowledgment

Turn 10. An acknowledgment records the stated confirmation; it does not automatically prove understanding of every example or compliant conduct.

6. job aid

Turn 12. A job aid can support the task by stating the disclosure trigger, timing, and advice route without replacing the governing policy.

7. role-based training

Turn 14. Role-based training adapts examples to relevant tasks and risks while preserving the actual policy requirement.

8. advice channel

Turn 16. The advice channel gives employees a clear route for questions and should not treat a request for guidance as automatic misconduct.

9. accessibility

Turn 18. Accessibility includes usable wording and format for the audience; a recorded completion does not prove the material was readily understood.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. follow-up assessment

Turn 20. The follow-up assessment checks the specific timing and outcome distinction rather than substituting another attendance count for understanding.

Return to the conversation, page 90

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What should be said about the 40% application result?

D. It describes eight correct answers among twenty volunteers, with representativeness unestablished.

A volunteer result has a defined scope and cannot automatically be generalized or treated as a causal finding.

Return to the exercise, page 93

F2. Which follow-up is most relevant?

C. A clear W4 example, an advice route, and a later check of the same disclosure-timing distinction

The response targets the demonstrated application difficulty and supports questions rather than merely increasing an activity count.

Return to the exercise, page 93

F / Guided speaking

1. 95%

Coordinator: The completion rate is 95%.

Turn 1. Two hundred eighty-five divided by three hundred equals ninety-five percent.

2. fifteen

Adviser: The number without recorded completion is fifteen.

Turn 2. Three hundred minus two hundred eighty-five leaves fifteen assigned employees.

3. 60%

Coordinator: The volunteer correct-answer rate is 60%.

Turn 3. Eighteen divided by thirty equals sixty percent for that separate group.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

4. representativeness

Adviser: Generalizing that result requires assessing representativeness.

Turn 4. A volunteer result does not automatically describe the entire assigned population.

Return to the conversation, page 94

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Completion is not the same as understanding". Sofia: "Some roles rarely face this issue, while others receive outside-work offers regularly. We should not assume one long module fits them equally." Ren: [missing response] Sofia: "A few employees hesitate to ask because they think a question will be treated as evidence that they did something wrong." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Use role-based training with relevant examples. Keep the rule consistent, but make the situations recognizable to the employees who need to apply it.

A Correct. This is Ren's response in turn 14. It connects Sofia's preceding point with Sofia's follow-up. Role-based training adapts examples to relevant tasks and risks while preserving the actual policy requirement.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Sofia says: "I will review the wording and format as well. Some of the examples rely on expressions that are hard for multilingual teams to interpret." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Sofia says: "Someone showed me the policy on their phone. They could not find the weekend example. Could we put the trigger and advice contact in a short reminder?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Sofia says: "After the revised example, we can ask another fixed scenario about when disclosure is needed and what disclosure does not automatically mean." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 94

08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Why was G12 marked complete?

B. The plan was approved on 12 September.

The tracker confused plan approval with the separate closure requirements.

Return to the exercise, page 96

A2. What evidence is needed for closure under the stated rule?

B. Implementation evidence and independent verification

The fictional closure rule requires both implementation support and independent verification.

Return to the exercise, page 96

A3. What is the status of 15 October?

D. Requested but not approved

Owen has requested the new date, but no authorized extension is recorded.

Return to the exercise, page 96

D / Response choices

D1. Which 1 October status is accurate?

A. Open and overdue; plan approved, implementation and verification evidence outstanding.

The original deadline has passed and neither closure evidence nor an approved extension is available.

Return to the exercise, page 100

D2. What would an approved extension establish by itself?

D. An authorized timing change under its stated conditions

A timing decision does not substitute for execution, evidence, verification, or separate risk authority.

Return to the exercise, page 100

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The participation requirement for a body to conduct specified business under its rules. Which term fits?

A. quorum

A Correct. quorum: The participation requirement for a body to conduct specified business under its rules. The usual combination is "verify quorum".

B Not here. mitigation plan: Proposed actions intended to reduce a specified risk. The usual combination is "approve a mitigation plan".

C Not here. closure criterion: A condition required to mark an action closed. The usual combination is "apply closure criteria".

D Not here. overdue action: An action whose applicable due date has passed without completion. The usual combination is "report overdue actions".

Return to the exercise, page 100

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "An approved plan is not a closed action". Owen: "The plan took weeks to agree. If the paper just says overdue, that work disappears. Can we show the milestone without calling the action closed?" Sara: [missing response] Owen: "Can I describe it as ninety percent complete? That might communicate that the plan is nearly ready to deliver." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. The status date lets us be precise. We will show the achieved milestone and the outstanding evidence together. Accurate overdue reporting does not erase the work already completed.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Owen says: "I will keep myself listed as the delivery owner, but the business risk owner should speak to the consequences and any interim measures." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Owen says: "If the committee agrees to the new date, would that count as accepting the remaining risk until then?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Sara's response in turn 6. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. The status date fixes the report at 1 October, when plan approval exists but the original deadline has passed without closure evidence.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Owen says: "G12 is marked complete in the tracker. The plan was approved on the twelfth of September, so I assumed we could close the action." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 100

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

E / Conversation

1. closure criteria

Turn 2. The stated closure criteria require implementation evidence and independent verification, not merely an approved remediation plan.

2. proposed extension

Turn 4. The requested 15 October date remains proposed because no authorized extension decision has been recorded.

3. status date

Turn 6. The status date fixes the report at 1 October, when plan approval exists but the original deadline has passed without closure evidence.

4. Implementation evidence

Turn 8. Implementation evidence must show the change actually operating or deployed as required; an unsupported completion percentage cannot replace it.

5. independent verification

Turn 10. Independent verification requires the appropriately separate reviewer to assess the required evidence rather than accept the owner's completion label.

6. residual exposure

Turn 12. Residual exposure describes the risk still present while implementation and verification remain unresolved, not an assumed benefit from plan approval.

7. decision rights

Turn 14. Decision rights determine who may extend timing or accept risk; one approval does not automatically authorize the other.

8. action owner

Turn 16. The action owner delivers the defined work, while risk ownership and authorized acceptance may belong to different roles.

9. decision log

Turn 18. The decision log preserves the original deadline and the authorized change, including its reason, authority, date, and conditions.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

10. exception reporting

Turn 20. Exception reporting makes the departure from the deadline and closure criteria visible so the committee can make the actual required decision.

Return to the conversation, page 102

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which record should be retained if timing changes?

C. The original deadline, extension decision, authority, reason, and new conditions

A traceable decision history explains both the original status and the authorized change.

Return to the exercise, page 106

F2. What should the committee paper request?

B. The specific extension decision and any separate action needed for remaining exposure

A decision-ready paper identifies the actual request and keeps unresolved evidence and risk questions visible.

Return to the exercise, page 106

F / Guided speaking

1. 12 June

Coordinator: The status date is 12 June.

Turn 1. The report describes the position as of 12 June, after the original due date.

2. open and overdue

Owner: The current action status is open and overdue.

Turn 2. The due date has passed, closure evidence is missing, and no extension is approved.

3. proposed extension

Coordinator: The twenty-fifth of June is a proposed extension.

Turn 3. A requested date does not become the applicable deadline before authorization.

4. independent verification

Owner: Closure also requires independent verification.

Turn 4. The stated closure rule requires verification as well as implementation evidence, not only plan approval.

Return to the conversation, page 107

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "An approved plan is not a closed action". Owen: "If the committee agrees to the new date, would that count as accepting the remaining risk until then?" Sara: [missing response] Owen: "I will keep myself listed as the delivery owner, but the business risk owner should speak to the consequences and any interim measures." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. We must check the decision rights. A timing extension and risk acceptance are different decisions. The committee's mandate and any delegated authority determine what it can actually decide.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Owen says: "I will keep myself listed as the delivery owner, but the business risk owner should speak to the consequences and any interim measures." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Owen says: "The plan took weeks to agree. If the paper just says overdue, that work disappears. Can we show the milestone without calling the action closed?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Owen says: "G12 is marked complete in the tracker. The plan was approved on the twelfth of September, so I assumed we could close the action." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Sara's response in turn 14. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. Decision rights determine who may extend timing or accept risk; one approval does not automatically authorize the other.

Return to the exercise, page 107

Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Assessing a request to determine its route, priority, and next action. Which term fits?

D. triage

A Not here. unsigned proposal: Proposed terms that have not been signed in the supplied record. The usual combination is "identify an unsigned proposal".

B Not here. agreement type: The category of contract or document being requested. The usual combination is "identify the agreement type".

C Not here. routing rule: A criterion determining where a request is sent. The usual combination is "apply routing rules".

D Correct. triage: Assessing a request to determine its route, priority, and next action. The usual combination is "triage the request".

Return to the exercise, page 29

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A control intended to stop an unwanted event before it occurs. Which term fits?

C. preventive control

A Not here. commitment: An undertaking or obligation whose relevant meaning depends on the context. The usual combination is "verify commitment status".

B Not here. policy: An organization's stated rule or principle for decisions and behavior. The usual combination is "publish a policy".

C Correct. preventive control: A control intended to stop an unwanted event before it occurs. The usual combination is "design a preventive control".

D Not here. segregation of duties: Allocation of incompatible responsibilities to different roles where required. The usual combination is "assess segregation of duties".

Return to the exercise, page 29

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction". Ben: "Nell needs a decision about whether to proceed by the sixth of October at noon UTC. She hopes to sign by the ninth." Mina: [missing response] Ben: "The pilot will use customer contact details. I am not sure whether the supplier only views them or also stores a copy." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. That gives us a specific decision deadline and a separate target signature date. I will record both and the business consequence of delay, but those dates do not establish reviewer availability or approval.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Ben says: "The proposal is for a two-month pilot costing forty thousand dollars. I attached the confidentiality agreement we signed earlier as well." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Ben says: "The pilot will use customer contact details. I am not sure whether the supplier only views them or also stores a copy." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Ben says: "The supplier keeps chasing. Could we say today, even though the reviewer is not confirmed?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 10. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. The decision is needed on 6 October at noon UTC, separately from the desired 9 October signature.

Return to the exercise, page 29

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The policy is published, but the check has no owner". Dinesh: "Once we document these roles and test a sample request, can we say the control has always worked?" Mara: [missing response] Dinesh: "Then we should separate the completed publication task from the operational work still needed, and assign the expense check explicitly." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. No. We can assess the design effectiveness of the defined process. A current walkthrough does not prove how earlier requests were handled or fill missing historical evidence.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Dinesh says: "We normally check receipts after the meal. For this one, nothing is booked. Where should our check sit before somebody commits the money?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Dinesh says: "Then we should separate the completed publication task from the operational work still needed, and assign the expense check explicitly." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Dinesh says: "I found an approval in one mailbox and the estimate in another. We need to join those records before we can show what was actually approved." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Mara's response in turn 18. It connects Dinesh's preceding point with Dinesh's follow-up. Design effectiveness concerns whether the proposed control addresses its objective, not proof that it operated throughout past periods.

Return to the exercise, page 29

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Prepared-by-client list; an auditor's requested information schedule in relevant practice. Which term fits?

D. PBC list

A Not here. sign-off: A recorded approval or confirmation under the relevant process. The usual combination is "verify reviewer sign-off".

B Not here. retrospective account: A later description of an earlier event. The usual combination is "label a retrospective account".

C Not here. review package: The linked records supporting a particular review. The usual combination is "assemble the review package".

D Correct. PBC list: Prepared-by-client list; an auditor's requested information schedule in relevant practice. The usual combination is "maintain the PBC list".

Return to the exercise, page 54

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Additional evidence supporting an account or claim. Which term fits?

A. corroboration

A Correct. corroboration: Additional evidence supporting an account or claim. The usual combination is "seek corroboration".

B Not here. intake note: The initial record of a reported concern and its source. The usual combination is "prepare a neutral intake note".

C Not here. allegation: A claim that something occurred, not necessarily established as fact. The usual combination is "record an allegation".

D Not here. confidentiality: Controlled handling of information under applicable duties and limits. The usual combination is "explain confidentiality limits".

Return to the exercise, page 54

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The policy is published, but the check has no owner". Dinesh: "What should the intake check record besides the amount? I want the evidence to be useful without collecting unnecessary information." Mara: [missing response] Dinesh: "I found an approval in one mailbox and the estimate in another. We need to join those records before we can show what was actually approved." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The control evidence should connect the request, purpose, relevant parties, cost calculation, decision, reviewer, and timing. Use the approved fields and handling rules, and retain what the process actually requires.

A Correct. This is Mara's response in turn 10. It connects Dinesh's preceding point with Dinesh's follow-up. Control evidence links the request, relevant calculation, authorized decision, reviewer, and timing to the actual event.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Dinesh says: "We normally check receipts after the meal. For this one, nothing is booked. Where should our check sit before somebody commits the money?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Dinesh says: "We can check the information on receipt, but my team should not be deciding whether the hospitality is permissible." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Dinesh says: "The estimate is nine hundred sixty dollars for eight guests, including all charges. Someone thought the total had to exceed a thousand." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 54

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding". Elena: "I have not had my shifts changed yet, but I fear that could happen if the manager thinks I complained." Noah: [missing response] Elena: "Please read it back. I want the invoice checked; I never said I saw a payment." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I will record that retaliation concern separately and route it promptly under the relevant process. Please distinguish any later event from the fear you are describing now, and use the designated contact if something changes.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Elena says: "No. The timing looked suspicious to me, but I did not see money change hands or a payment record." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Elena says: "I remember the date clearly, although I would need to check my notes for the time. I do not want to guess." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Elena says: "The manager is close to someone on the usual review team. I am concerned that the report could go straight back to them." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Noah's response in turn 18. It connects Elena's preceding point with Elena's follow-up. The fear of adverse shift changes is a separate concern, not a statement that a shift change has already occurred.

Return to the exercise, page 54

Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Subject access request; a request to exercise the relevant right of access. Which term fits?

A. SAR

A Correct. SAR: Subject access request; a request to exercise the relevant right of access. The usual combination is "recognize a SAR".

B Not here. receipt timestamp: The recorded date and time the request arrived. The usual combination is "preserve the receipt timestamp".

C Not here. third-party information: Information relating to someone other than the requester. The usual combination is "review third-party information".

D Not here. identity verification: Proportionate checking that the person is who they claim to be. The usual combination is "complete identity verification".

Return to the exercise, page 82

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A downstream provider on which a direct supplier relies. Which term fits?

D. fourth party

A Not here. inherent risk: Risk considered before the specified controls or responses. The usual combination is "assess inherent risk".

B Not here. security questionnaire: A structured set of questions about a supplier's security practices. The usual combination is "evaluate questionnaire responses".

C Not here. due diligence: Appropriate investigation before or during a relationship to understand relevant facts and risks. The usual combination is "conduct vendor due diligence".

D Correct. fourth party: A downstream provider on which a direct supplier relies. The usual combination is "assess fourth-party dependencies".

Return to the exercise, page 82

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding". Elena: "I remember the date clearly, although I would need to check my notes for the time. I do not want to guess." Noah: [missing response] Elena: "I have my own notes and a message about the invoice. I have not changed them or accessed anyone else's account." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Keep that distinction in the chronology. We can record the date you recall and mark the time as unconfirmed. The reviewer can assess relevant records and context rather than rely on invented precision.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Elena says: "Can you guarantee that my manager will never learn that I contacted you? I am worried about how this could affect my work." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Noah's response in turn 10. It connects Elena's preceding point with Elena's follow-up. The chronology should preserve known dates and uncertain times rather than inserting a guess as a precise fact.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Elena says: "A colleague may have seen the same screen. Should I ask them to agree with my account before you take it further?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Elena says: "I saw V19 marked approved on the twenty-seventh of September, but the receiving field was blank. I think my manager is getting a payoff." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 82

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure". Paolo: "If some uncertainty remains after those checks, can the business record it and decide whether to proceed?" Imani: [missing response] Paolo: "I will request the data-flow details and field rationale, and keep both vendors unapproved until the relevant decision is made." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Any risk acceptance must follow the actual authority framework. The decision-maker needs the remaining exposure and evidence gaps, not a summary that hides them behind a favorable demonstration.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Paolo says: "B's demonstration was easier to use. Both vendors produce workforce reports, so I hoped the risk review could be the same for each." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Paolo says: "We need department-level planning. A proposes counts by department, while B asks for employee names, work emails, and individual salaries." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Paolo says: "We have not been told where the hosting and support activities occur. Should I put our own country in the form for now?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Imani's response in turn 18. It connects Paolo's preceding point with Paolo's follow-up. Risk acceptance is an authorized decision about defined remaining exposure, not permission created by an incomplete intake form.

Return to the exercise, page 82

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The defined group required to complete a learning activity. Which term fits?

D. assigned cohort

A Not here. application question: A question testing use of a rule in a concrete situation. The usual combination is "design an application question".

B Not here. volunteer sample: A group whose members choose to participate. The usual combination is "qualify a volunteer sample".

C Not here. localization: Adaptation of material for a particular language, setting, or audience. The usual combination is "review localization".

D Correct. assigned cohort: The defined group required to complete a learning activity. The usual combination is "verify the assigned cohort".

Return to the exercise, page 109

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The person accountable for managing a specified risk under the framework. Which term fits?

D. risk owner

A Not here. KRI: Key risk indicator; a defined measure used to monitor risk conditions. The usual combination is "interpret a KRI".

B Not here. governance: The structures and processes for direction, oversight, and accountability. The usual combination is "support effective governance".

C Not here. proposed extension: A requested change to timing that has not yet been approved. The usual combination is "record a proposed extension".

D Correct. risk owner: The person accountable for managing a specified risk under the framework. The usual combination is "identify the risk owner".

Return to the exercise, page 109

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure". Paolo: "We have not been told where the hosting and support activities occur. Should I put our own country in the form for now?" Imani: [missing response] Paolo: "A's proposal is simpler. Can we mark it low risk without asking anything further because it only mentions department counts?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Leave the location unconfirmed and flag possible cross-border transfers for the appropriate review. An assumed location can distort both the risk assessment and the contractual questions that follow.

A Correct. This is Imani's response in turn 10. It connects Paolo's preceding point with Paolo's follow-up. Unconfirmed storage or access locations require assessment; staff must not insert an assumed country to complete a form.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Paolo says: "We need department-level planning. A proposes counts by department, while B asks for employee names, work emails, and individual salaries." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Paolo says: "If some uncertainty remains after those checks, can the business record it and decide whether to proceed?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Paolo says: "B's demonstration was easier to use. Both vendors produce workforce reports, so I hoped the risk review could be the same for each." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 109

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An approved plan is not a closed action". Owen: "The tracker shows only one due-date field. If the extension is approved, where do we keep the original deadline and the committee's conditions?" Sara: [missing response] Owen: "Then the paper will show plan approved, evidence outstanding, overdue as of the first, and the requested fifteenth-of-October extension." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Update the current field while preserving the decision log. Retain the original deadline, the request, and any authorized decision with its reasons and conditions. Do not rewrite the history to imply the action was never overdue.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Owen says: "Can I describe it as ninety percent complete? That might communicate that the plan is nearly ready to deliver." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Owen says: "The original date was the thirtieth of September. I requested the fifteenth of October because the implementation work is taking longer." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Owen says: "For the seventh of October meeting, I want the committee to approve the revised date. What else should the paper make clear?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Sara's response in turn 18. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. The decision log preserves the original deadline and the authorized change, including its reason, authority, date, and conditions.

Return to the exercise, page 109

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. engagement terms

Turn 2. The agreed engagement terms set the associate rate at 300 dollars and partner rate at 500; the invoice cannot replace those terms with an unapproved rate.

2. rate adjustment

Turn 4. Twelve hours multiplied by the 25-dollar rate difference produces a 300-dollar reduction; the hours themselves are unchanged.

3. duplicate entry

Turn 6. Counsel has confirmed that one of the four partner hours is duplicated, supporting a separate 500-dollar removal rather than an assumption based only on similar text.

4. revised invoice

Turn 8. The revised invoice is 3,600 associate fees plus 1,500 partner fees plus 150 expense, totaling 5,250, with no tax or discount in the exercise.

5. block billing

Turn 12. Block billing combines multiple tasks in one time entry; this fictional client's guidelines require a factual task breakdown, not invented allocations to make the entry pass review.

6. matter owner

Turn 16. The matter owner holds payment-approval responsibility in the supplied workflow; legal operations checking arithmetic does not itself authorize payment.

Return to the conversation, page 112

Transfer exchange

1. 200

Analyst: The rate correction alone reduces the bill by $200 .

Turn 1. Ten hours times the twenty-dollar rate difference equals two hundred dollars before duplicate hours are removed.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. 400

Coordinator: Removing the two duplicates at the agreed rate reduces it by another $400 .

Turn 2. Two hours at the corrected two-hundred-dollar rate equal four hundred, avoiding double-counting the rate adjustment.

3. 1700

Analyst: Eight valid hours plus the expense produce a corrected total of $1700 .

Turn 3. Eight times two hundred equals sixteen hundred, plus the allowed hundred-dollar expense gives seventeen hundred.

4. approval

Coordinator: Correct arithmetic does not establish payment approval .

Turn 4. The facts leave payment approval outstanding even though the corrected rate and hours can be reconciled.

Return to the conversation, page 115

Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. preservation

Turn 2. Preservation means protecting the relevant information from loss or alteration; an active email hold alone does not establish that chat and shared files are protected.

2. custodian list

Turn 4. The custodian list identifies the people whose relevant records fall within the supplied hold; names and accounts must be matched rather than assuming one mailbox covers every source.

3. deletion suspension

Turn 6. Deletion suspension stops the relevant scheduled removal within the hold's scope; sending a notice or opening a ticket is not evidence that the technical protection is effective.

4. acknowledgment

Turn 10. An acknowledgment confirms receipt or the specified response to a hold notice; it does not prove technical preservation or resolve missing responses from other custodians.

5. scope

Turn 12. The scope defines the relevant subject, custodians, dates, and sources; uncertainty about another location requires clarification rather than unauthorized collection or silent exclusion.

6. hold release

Turn 18. A hold release requires the authorized legal decision in this scenario; an expected settlement date does not end preservation or override another applicable hold or retention duty.

Return to the conversation, page 117

Transfer exchange

1. email

Coordinator: Verified preservation currently covers email only.

Turn 1. The stated evidence confirms email preservation, while the requested chat setting has not yet been verified.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. chat

Administrator: The unresolved source requiring urgent follow-through is chat .

Turn 2. Chat is within the hold but lacks verified protection, so the pending request is not sufficient evidence of completion.

3. records

Coordinator: Ending Jo's access is distinct from deleting Jo's records .

Turn 3. Access removal concerns authorization to use systems; relevant records remain subject to the active preservation instructions.

4. release

Administrator: The departure itself does not authorize a hold release .

Turn 4. Counsel has not released H44, and an employee's departure does not end the stated preservation requirement.

Return to the conversation, page 120

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. notice clause

Turn 2. The notice clause specifies receipt at the designated address by 31 October at 17:00 UTC; an informal email to a salesperson is not confirmed compliance with those supplied terms.

2. non-renewal

Turn 4. Non-renewal prevents the next contract term under the applicable terms, whereas ending service before the current term expires would be a different termination question.

3. approval requirement

Turn 6. The supplied internal approval requirement remains unmet; the department's decision does not by itself establish the authorized signatory's approval.

4. notice deadline

Turn 8. The notice deadline is 31 October at 17:00 UTC, distinct from the current term ending on 30 November; using the term end would miss the supplied notice requirement.

5. receipt

Turn 10. Receipt concerns the notice reaching the specified recipient under the clause; an intention to forward or a sent-message record alone does not establish that event.

6. Remaining obligations

Turn 16. Remaining obligations can include the current term's agreed charges and other contractual duties; a non-renewal notice does not automatically waive them or establish a final settlement.

Return to the conversation, page 122

Transfer exchange

1. non-renewal

Owner: The intended action is non-renewal, not immediate termination.

Turn 1. The business wants the current term to continue through August but does not want the following term to begin.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. 12:00

Administrator: The specified notice deadline is 31 July at 12:00 UTC.

Turn 2. The notice clause expressly sets noon UTC on 31 July, not the later service-end date.

3. receipt

Owner: The bounced email does not establish receipt .

Turn 3. A failed delivery does not show the notice reached the contractually specified recipient, even though a send attempt exists.

4. reminder

Administrator: We must urgently resolve delivery rather than close the reminder .

Turn 4. The receipt requirement remains unfulfilled on the supplied facts, so the task needs urgent follow-through rather than administrative closure.

Return to the conversation, page 125

Find a phrase by purpose

Contract Intake and Workflow

Acknowledge the request: I have received L17 and the attached proposal.

Explain the missing facts: To route it correctly, I need the agreement type, business owner, and decision date.

Clarify the transaction: What services will the two-month pilot actually include?

Full phrase bank, page 7

Policy Implementation and Controls

State the gap: The policy is published, but the check has no assigned operator.

Name the objective: The control should prevent commitments that lack required preapproval.

Apply the correct basis: The threshold is per guest, including all charges.

Full phrase bank, page 20

Compliance Audits and Evidence

Confirm the scope: You are requesting the monthly reviews for January through March 2026.

State what is available: We have located the January and February packages.

Disclose the gap: We have not yet located the March package.

Full phrase bank, page 34

Internal Investigations

Acknowledge the report: Thank you for raising the concern; I will record what you tell me accurately.

Ask about observation: What did you personally see or hear?

Separate interpretation: Which part is your conclusion about what the event meant?

Full phrase bank, page 45

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Privacy Operations and Data Requests

Recognize the substance: The message asks for access and deletion, even though it uses ordinary language.

Preserve receipt: Record the first of October at zero nine hundred UTC.

Keep the wording: Retain the original message as well as the operational summary.

Full phrase bank, page 59

Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence

Acknowledge the benefit: The demonstration suggests B may be easier for the team to use.

Clarify the purpose: Which decisions does the reporting service need to support?

Compare the inputs: A proposes department counts; B requests person-level salary and contact data.

Full phrase bank, page 72

Training, Attestations, and Culture

Name the measure: Ninety-eight percent refers to recorded training completion.

State the denominator: Four hundred ninety of five hundred assigned employees completed it.

Keep the remainder visible: Ten assigned employees lack recorded completion.

Full phrase bank, page 87

Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees

State the reporting date: This status is as of the first of October.

Credit the completed milestone: The remediation plan was approved on the twelfth of September.

Keep closure separate: Plan approval does not satisfy the closure criteria.

Full phrase bank, page 99

Vocabulary index

accessibility
Lesson 07, p. 86

acknowledgment
Lesson 07, p. 85, Case 2, p. 116

action owner
Lesson 08, p. 97

advice channel
Lesson 07, p. 86

agreement type
Lesson 01, p. 5

allegation
Lesson 04, p. 43

anonymity
Lesson 04, p. 44

application gap
Lesson 07, p. 86

application question
Lesson 07, p. 85

approval requirement
Case 3, p. 121

approved extension
Lesson 08, p. 98

approver
Lesson 02, p. 18

assigned cohort
Lesson 07, p. 85

assurance report
Lesson 06, p. 71

attestation
Lesson 07, p. 85

audit right
Lesson 06, p. 71

audit scope
Lesson 03, p. 32

audit trail
Lesson 03, p. 33

authorized representative
Lesson 05, p. 57

behavior measure
Lesson 07, p. 86

block billing
Case 1, p. 111

business owner
Lesson 01, p. 5

business rationale
Lesson 06, p. 69

case handoff
Lesson 04, p. 44

chronology
Lesson 04, p. 43

clarification
Lesson 05, p. 57

CLM
Lesson 01, p. 6

closure criterion
Lesson 08, p. 97

commitment
Lesson 02, p. 19

committee charter
Lesson 08, p. 97

completeness
Lesson 03, p. 33

completion criterion
Lesson 07, p. 85

completion rate
Lesson 07, p. 85

confidentiality
Lesson 04, p. 44

conflict of interest
Lesson 04, p. 44

contemporaneous evidence
Lesson 03, p. 33

contract package
Lesson 01, p. 6

contractual safeguard
Lesson 06, p. 70

contradictory evidence
Lesson 04, p. 43

control
Lesson 02, p. 18

control evidence
Lesson 02, p. 19

control frequency
Lesson 02, p. 19

control objective
Lesson 02, p. 18

control operator
Lesson 02, p. 18

Vocabulary index / continued

controller
Lesson 05, p. 58

corroboration
Lesson 04, p. 43

counterparty
Lesson 01, p. 5

cross-border transfer
Lesson 06, p. 69

custodian list
Case 2, p. 116

data flow
Lesson 06, p. 69

data minimization
Lesson 05, p. 58

data necessity
Lesson 06, p. 69

data subject
Lesson 05, p. 57

decision deadline
Lesson 01, p. 6

decision log
Lesson 08, p. 98

decision rights
Lesson 08, p. 97

delegated authority
Lesson 08, p. 97

deletion suspension
Case 2, p. 116

deletion verification
Lesson 06, p. 71

design effectiveness
Lesson 02, p. 19

detective control
Lesson 02, p. 18

DPA
Lesson 06, p. 70

DSAR
Lesson 05, p. 57

due diligence
Lesson 06, p. 69

duplicate entry
Case 1, p. 111

engagement terms
Case 1, p. 111

erasure request
Lesson 05, p. 57

escalation threshold
Lesson 08, p. 98

evidence gap
Lesson 03, p. 33

evidence repository
Lesson 02, p. 19

evidence request
Lesson 03, p. 32

exception
Lesson 02, p. 19

exception log
Lesson 03, p. 33

exception reporting
Lesson 08, p. 98

exemption
Lesson 05, p. 58

exit plan
Lesson 06, p. 71

factual attribution
Lesson 04, p. 44

finding
Lesson 04, p. 43

first-hand account
Lesson 04, p. 43

follow-up assessment
Lesson 07, p. 86

fourth party
Lesson 06, p. 69

governance
Lesson 08, p. 97

hearsay
Lesson 04, p. 43

hold release
Case 2, p. 116

identity verification
Lesson 05, p. 57

implementation evidence
Lesson 08, p. 97

implementation gap
Lesson 02, p. 19

incident notification
Lesson 06, p. 71

Vocabulary index / continued

independence
Lesson 04, p. 44

independent verification
Lesson 08, p. 97

inference
Lesson 04, p. 43

inherent risk
Lesson 06, p. 71

intake
Lesson 01, p. 5

intake note
Lesson 04, p. 44

investigation scope
Lesson 04, p. 44

issue escalation
Lesson 02, p. 19

job aid
Lesson 07, p. 85

jurisdiction
Lesson 05, p. 58

knowledge check
Lesson 07, p. 85

knowledge gap
Lesson 07, p. 86

KRI
Lesson 08, p. 98

learning objective
Lesson 07, p. 85

legal approval
Lesson 01, p. 6

legal entity
Lesson 01, p. 5

legal hold
Lesson 04, p. 44

LMS
Lesson 07, p. 85

localization
Lesson 07, p. 86

management response
Lesson 03, p. 33

matter
Lesson 01, p. 5

matter owner
Case 1, p. 111

metadata
Lesson 03, p. 32

mitigation plan
Lesson 08, p. 98

MSA
Lesson 01, p. 5

NDA
Lesson 01, p. 5

need-to-know access
Lesson 04, p. 44

non-renewal
Case 3, p. 121

notice clause
Case 3, p. 121

notice deadline
Case 3, p. 121

ongoing monitoring
Lesson 06, p. 71

onward disclosure
Lesson 06, p. 69

operating effectiveness
Lesson 02, p. 19

order form
Lesson 01, p. 5

overdue action
Lesson 08, p. 98

override
Lesson 02, p. 19

PBC list
Lesson 03, p. 32

personal data
Lesson 05, p. 57

plain language
Lesson 07, p. 86

policy
Lesson 02, p. 18

policy owner
Lesson 02, p. 18

population
Lesson 03, p. 32

preapproval
Lesson 02, p. 18

preservation
Lesson 04, p. 44, Case 2, p. 116

Vocabulary index / continued

preventive control
Lesson 02, p. 18

procedure
Lesson 02, p. 18

proportionality
Lesson 05, p. 57

provenance
Lesson 03, p. 32

quorum
Lesson 08, p. 97

receipt
Case 3, p. 121

rectification
Lesson 05, p. 57

relevance
Lesson 03, p. 33

Remaining obligations
Case 3, p. 121

remediation
Lesson 06, p. 71

reported observation
Lesson 04, p. 43

representativeness
Lesson 07, p. 86

request scope
Lesson 05, p. 57

residual exposure
Lesson 08, p. 97

response deadline
Lesson 05, p. 58

retention obligation
Lesson 05, p. 58

retention rule
Lesson 02, p. 19

review package
Lesson 03, p. 32

review scope
Lesson 01, p. 6

right of access
Lesson 05, p. 57

risk appetite
Lesson 08, p. 98

risk register
Lesson 08, p. 98

privileged access
Lesson 03, p. 32

processor
Lesson 05, p. 58

proposed extension
Lesson 08, p. 98

purpose limitation
Lesson 06, p. 69

rate adjustment
Case 1, p. 111

receipt timestamp
Lesson 05, p. 58

redaction
Lesson 03, p. 33

reliability
Lesson 03, p. 33

remedial learning
Lesson 07, p. 86

reperformance
Lesson 03, p. 33

reporter
Lesson 04, p. 43

request log
Lesson 05, p. 58

requester
Lesson 01, p. 5

residual risk
Lesson 06, p. 71

retaliation concern
Lesson 04, p. 44

retention period
Lesson 06, p. 71

retrospective account
Lesson 03, p. 33

review period
Lesson 03, p. 32

revised invoice
Case 1, p. 111

risk acceptance
Lesson 06, p. 71

risk owner
Lesson 08, p. 97

risk tolerance
Lesson 08, p. 98

Vocabulary index / continued

role-based training
Lesson 07, p. 85

routing rule
Lesson 01, p. 6

sample
Lesson 03, p. 32

SAR
Lesson 05, p. 57

scenario-based assessment
Lesson 07, p. 85

scope
Case 2, p. 116

search scope
Lesson 05, p. 58

secure disclosure
Lesson 05, p. 58

security questionnaire
Lesson 06, p. 71

segregation of duties
Lesson 02, p. 19

sign-off
Lesson 03, p. 33

signature authority
Lesson 01, p. 6

source record
Lesson 03, p. 32

SOW
Lesson 01, p. 5

speak-up culture
Lesson 07, p. 86

spend approval
Lesson 01, p. 6

status date
Lesson 08, p. 98

subcontractor
Lesson 06, p. 69

subject
Lesson 04, p. 43

subprocessor
Lesson 06, p. 69

target signature date
Lesson 01, p. 6

terms of reference
Lesson 08, p. 97

third-party information
Lesson 05, p. 58

threshold
Lesson 02, p. 18

timestamp
Lesson 03, p. 32

triage
Lesson 01, p. 5

trigger
Lesson 02, p. 18

turnaround estimate
Lesson 01, p. 6

unsigned proposal
Lesson 01, p. 6

version control
Lesson 01, p. 6

volunteer sample
Lesson 07, p. 86

witness
Lesson 04, p. 43

References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

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https://www.gao.gov/greenbook

Companion course

The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.

https://englishladder.com/efsp-legal-operations-compliance.html

Clarify the request. Preserve the evidence.

Eight lessons connect requests, controls, evidence, privacy, vendors, training, and governance. Three additional conversations cover outside-counsel billing, preservation, and contract notice.

Contract Intake and Workflow

The earlier NDA and the proposed services arrangement serve different purposes. Do not assume the NDA approves the pilot, spending, data processing, or signature. Reviewers need the relevant document package and actual parties, not an intake label alone.

Policy Implementation and Controls

The proposed meal is $960 divided by eight, or $120 per guest, so it exceeds the stated H3 threshold. That triggers review; it does not guarantee approval. Costs at or below $100 are not automatically acceptable because other restrictions still apply.

Compliance Audits and Evidence

Two located packages out of three requested months is a statement about evidence availability. It is not automatically a 66.7% control-effectiveness score. The March gap must be disclosed while the underlying activity and available alternative evidence are assessed.

Internal Investigations

The intake note should say Elena reports seeing an approved status and a blank receiving field. A blank field does not establish that goods were never received, that approval was improper, or that a payoff occurred. Those are separate questions for review.

Phil Stilwell

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